THE SOUTH AFRICAN ORGANIC SECTOR ORGANISATION (SAOSO)

STANDARD FOR ORGANIC PRODUCTION AND PROCESSING

Version 2.1
2026

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FOUNDATION OF THE SAOSO STANDARDS

The IFOAM NORMS for Organic Production and Processing Version 2014. © IFOAM-Organics International, October 2019 (Edited version of the IFOAM Norms 2014).

THE SOUTH AFRICAN ORGANIC SECTOR ORGANISATION (SAOSO) STANDARD FOR ORGANIC PRODUCTION AND PROCESSING. VERSION 1.7 (JUNE, 2020).

STANDARDS REFERENCED BY THIS STANDARD

COUNCIL REGULATION (EEC) No 2092/91 of 24 June 1991 on organic production of agricultural products and indications referring thereto on agricultural products and foodstuffs.

REGULATION (EU) 2018/848 OF THE EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT AND OF THE COUNCIL of 30 May 2018 on organic production and labelling of organic products and repealing Council Regulation (EC) No 834/2007.

NATIONAL STANDARD OF CANADA. CAN/CGSB-32.310-2020. Organic production systems. General principles and management standards.

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Evaluation matrix for the equivalence assessment of the SAOSO Standard against the Common Objectives and Requirements of Organic Standards
Assessment summary sheet

Standard name: The South African Organic Sector Organization (SAOSO) Standard for Organic Production and Processing
Standard owner: SAOSO Assessed version: 2 (2023)

Note: the standard has a section on the breeding of organic varieties, which is not included in this assessment. The standard has a section on approval, verification and equivalence, which is outside the scope of this assessment.

	Yes	No	Comment
Does the standard respect the Principles of Organic Agriculture?	X		
Does the standard sufficiently cover all 10 COROS objectives? If no, which objectives are not covered or not sufficiently covered?	X		The standard covers well the 10 objectives.
Does the entire standard clearly distinguish organic systems from conventional systems?	X		
Overall, are the lists of approved substances in the standard equivalent to the lists in the reference international standard?	X		The lists are equivalent to the lists in the IFOAM Standard.
Overall, are variations acceptable?	X		
Does acceptance of the standard prejudice consumer trust in organic or the reputation of the body accepting the standard?		X	
What are the main areas of important positive variations in the standard?	Conversion periods; fertility requirements; substance use in livestock housing; grazing requirements; some quality & authenticity requirements in processing; fair working conditions.		
What are the main areas of important unjustified negative variations in the standard?	none		

IS THE STANDARD EQUIVALENT TO THE COROS?	X		The Standard scores very well against the COROS.
Scopes for which the standard is approved in the IFOAM Family of Standards	Crop production, Animal production, Wild collection, Processing and handling.		
Scopes for which the standard is NOT approved in the IFOAM Family of Standards	None		

This is the summary of an equivalence assessment against the COROS (Common Objectives and Requirements of Organic Standards, also called IFOAM Standards Requirements, conducted by IFOAM-Organics International in the frame of the IFOAM Family of Standards. The full detailed assessment is available on request (please write to ogs@ifoam.bio). For more information on the IFOAM Family of Standards, visit https://www.ifoam.bio/en/ifoam-family-standards-0.

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SECTION A - 1

INTRODUCTION - THE PRINCIPLES OF ORGANIC AGRICULTURE

1. PREAMBLE

The last number of years has seen a substantial growth in the awareness and marketing of organic agriculture products. This development of organics has also brought an additional need for assurance and quality management. As organic agriculture in South Africa enters the mainstream economy, it has to comply with and conform to its rules of engagement. This means that claims regarding the organic integrity of a product needs to be independently verified for compliance to international standards for customers' confidence. It is also clear that local markets and small growers are not exempt from this need for assurance based on international standards through Participatory Guarantee Systems.

Before one can describe the standard for organic production and processing, one has to agree on a common definition of organic agriculture. This standard is based on the Standard for Organic Production and Processing (as amended) of IFOAM Organics International, as well as on the global organisation's Definition and Principles of Organic Agriculture as adopted by the IFOAM World Board in 2008:

These Principles are the roots from which organic agriculture grows and develops. They express the contribution that organic agriculture can make to the world, and a vision to improve all agriculture in a global context. This standard is a living document responding to the developing organic sector and is periodically reviewed and updated.

Agriculture is one of humankind's most basic activities because all people need to nourish themselves daily. History, culture and community values are embedded in agriculture. The Principles apply to agriculture in the broadest sense, including the way people tend soils, water, plants and animals in order to produce, prepare and distribute food and other goods. They concern the way people interact with living landscapes, relate to one another and shape the legacy of future generations.

The Principles of Organic Agriculture serve to inspire the organic movement in its full diversity. They guide IFOAM-Organics International 's development of positions, programs and standards. Furthermore, they are presented with a vision of their world- wide adoption.

Organic agriculture is based on:

The Principle of Health

The Principle of Ecology

The Principle of Fairness

The Principle of Care

Each principle is articulated through a statement followed by an explanation. The principles are to be used as a whole. They are composed as ethical principles to inspire action.

2. THE IFOAM ORGANICS INTERNATIONAL DEFINITION AND PRINCIPLES

"Organic agriculture is a production system that sustains the health of soils, ecosystems and people. It relies on ecological processes, biodiversity and cycles adapted to local conditions, rather than the use of inputs with adverse effects. Organic agriculture combines tradition, innovation and science to benefit the shared environment and promote fair relationships and a good quality of life for all involved."

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2.1. Principle of Health

Organic Agriculture should sustain and enhance the health of soil, plant, animal, human and planet as one and indivisible.

This principle points out that the health of individuals and communities cannot be separated from the health of ecosystems - healthy soils produce healthy crops that foster the health of animals and people.

Health is the wholeness and integrity of living systems. It is not simply the absence of illness, but the maintenance of physical, mental, social and ecological well-being. Immunity, resilience and regeneration are key characteristics of health.

The role of organic agriculture, whether in farming, processing, distribution, or consumption, is to sustain and enhance the health of ecosystems and organisms from the smallest in the soil to human beings. In particular, organic agriculture is intended to produce high quality, nutritious food that contributes to preventive health care and well-being. In view of this it should avoid the use of fertilizers, pesticides, animal drugs and food additives that may have adverse health effects.

2.2. Principle of Ecology

Organic Agriculture should be based on living ecological systems and cycles, work with them, emulate them and help sustain them.

This principle roots organic agriculture within living ecological systems. It states that production is to be based on ecological processes, and recycling. Nourishment and well-being are achieved through the ecology of the specific production environment. For example, in the case of crops this is the living soil; for animals it is the farm ecosystem; for fish and marine organisms, the aquatic environment.

Organic farming, pastoral and wild harvest systems should fit the cycles and ecological balances in nature. These cycles are universal but their operation is site-specific. Organic management must be adapted to local conditions, ecology, culture and scale. Inputs should be reduced by reuse, recycling and efficient management of materials and energy in order to maintain and improve environmental quality and conserve resources.

Organic agriculture should attain ecological balance through the design of farming systems, establishment of habitats and maintenance of genetic and agricultural diversity. Those who produce, process, trade, or consume organic products should protect and benefit the common environment including landscapes, climate, habitats, biodiversity, air and water.

2.3. Principle of Fairness

Organic Agriculture should build on relationships that ensure fairness with regard to the common environment and life opportunities.

Fairness is characterized by equity, respect, justice and stewardship of the shared world, both among people and in their relations to other living beings.

This principle emphasizes that those involved in organic agriculture should conduct human relationships in a manner that ensures fairness at all levels and to all parties - farmers, workers, processors, distributors, traders and consumers. Organic agriculture should provide everyone involved with a good quality of life, and contribute to food sovereignty and reduction of poverty. It aims to produce a sufficient supply of good quality food and other products.

This principle insists that animals should be provided with the conditions and opportunities of life that accord with their physiology, natural behaviour and well- being.

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Natural and environmental resources that are used for production and consumption should be managed in a way that is socially and ecologically just and should be held in trust for future generations. Fairness requires systems of production, distribution and trade that are open and equitable and account for real environmental and social costs.

2.4. Principle of Care

Organic Agriculture should be managed in a precautionary and responsible manner to protect the health and well-being of current and future generations and the environment.

Organic agriculture is a living and dynamic system that responds to internal and external demands and conditions. Practitioners of organic agriculture can enhance efficiency and increase productivity, but this should not be at the risk of jeopardizing health and well-being. Consequently, new technologies need to be assessed and existing methods reviewed. Given the incomplete understanding of ecosystems and agriculture, care must be taken.

This principle states that precaution and responsibility are the key concerns in management, development and technology choices in organic agriculture. Science is necessary to ensure that organic agriculture is healthy, safe and ecologically sound. However, scientific knowledge alone is not sufficient. Practical experience, accumulated wisdom and traditional and indigenous knowledge offer valid solutions, tested by time. Organic agriculture should prevent significant risks by adopting appropriate technologies and rejecting unpredictable ones, such as genetic engineering. Decisions should reflect the values and needs of all who might be affected, through transparent and participatory processes.

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SECTION A - 2

GENERAL

1. BASIS OF THE SAOSO STANDARDS

The South African Organic Sector Organisation (SAOSO) is a member of the International Federation of Organic Agricultural Movements (IFOAM-Organics International). As such it supports IFOAM's objective of harmonising global standards. SAOSO therefore has adopted the IFOAM Norms for Organic Production and Processing Version 2014 (the IFOAM Norms) using the latest edition at the time of writing this Standard as the basis of the SAOSO Standard, hereinafter referred to in the text body as "the Standard".

Additional context sensitive South African specific clauses are included to cater for specific South African circumstances, such as the poultry and aquaculture derogations which facilitate the development of these enterprises for sale of produce into the South African domestic market. In this way the harmonisation of the Standard with the IFOAM Norms is assured. Derogations have a limited life of 5 years from the date of publication of this Standard. Thereafter the need for the derogation must be reviewed and revoked or extended for a further limited time period as necessary.

2. THE INTENTION OF THE SAOSO STANDARDS

It is envisaged that the South African Government will, through appropriate legislation, formally recognise the South African Bureau of Standards (SABS) SANS 1369 Standard as the National South African Standard and the SAOSO Standard as being a formal implementation thereof.

It is further envisaged through this process that the Standard may, by virtue of its membership to the IFOAM Family of Standards, be considered as being regionally appropriate and applicable within the greater Southern African Development Community (SADC), facilitating trade within the community.

Further, the Standard will be accepted internationally by those countries which recognise the IFOAM Family of Standards.

3. SCOPE OF THE SAOSO STANDARDS

Organic agriculture (also known as "Biological" or "Ecological" agriculture or protected equivalent terms in other languages) is a whole system approach based upon a set of processes resulting in a sustainable ecosystem, safe food, good nutrition, animal welfare and social justice. Therefore, organic production is more than a system of production that includes or excludes certain inputs. IFOAM-Organics International defines organic agriculture as "a production system that sustains the health of soils, ecosystems and people. It relies on ecological processes, biodiversity and cycles adapted to local conditions. Organic agriculture combines tradition, innovation and science to benefit the shared environment and promote fair relationships and a good quality of life for all involved".

The IFOAM Standard is an internationally applicable organic standard developed by IFOAM-Organics International. It is a good, practical interpretation of the IFOAM Standards Requirements (Common Objectives and Requirements of Organic Standards), hence belongs to the IFOAM Family of Standards. IFOAM-Organics International recognizes the need to harmonize organic standards worldwide whenever possible, but also the need to have organic standards that are regionally adapted.

The Standards are written in such a way that producers wishing to follow either standard may use it in the context of third-party certification, Participatory Guarantee Systems (PGS), Community Supported Agriculture (CSA), or simply self-commitment.

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Record keeping and other certification requirements are not within the Normative scope of the Standards. However, Informative sections have been included to provide guidance in those instances where no other guidance may be in place. Therefore, the Standards should be seen as a reference resource, as much as a Standard, being for the producer a "first stop" when looking for answers to organic production and associated claims.

The Standards contain provisions for regional variations, in the form of regional or other exceptions. The Standards include further specific clauses which may be Normative (prescriptive), or exceptions, or Informative (guidance). They can be permission(s) granted to an operator to be excluded from the need to comply with normal requirements of the standard. These exceptions (or derogations) are to be understood as typically requiring approval from the control body (see definition of control body). Documented exceptions must be granted on the basis of clear criteria, with clear justification and for a limited time period only. In the context of third-party certification, and especially under the IFOAM Accreditation Program, these exceptions are left to the decision of the certification body and require certification body approval before being implemented. Under a PGS scheme, they would also require a decision by the relevant decision-making level within the scheme, usually the same level as makes / validates the certification decisions. Under a CSA or other consumer-driven schemes, it is proposed that the producer submits exception requests to the decision of their consumer base.

The Standards cover the areas of general organic management, crop production (including plant breeding), animal production, beekeeping, insect production, aquaculture, wild collection, wine making, processing and handling, labelling, and social justice.

The Standards are complementary and additional to all other relevant statutory requirements.

4. STRUCTURE

Requirements in the Standards are organized according to the following structure:

- Section A – 1. Introduction - The Principles of Organic Agriculture
- Section A – 2. General
- Section A – 3. Minimum Inspection Requirements and Precautionary Measures
- Section B – 1. Definitions
- Section B – 2. Organic Ecosystems
- Section B – 3. General Requirements for Crop Production and Animal Husbandry
- Section B – 4. Crop Production
- Section B – 5. Animal Husbandry
- Section B – 6. Wild Harvesting of Plants
- Section B – 7. Bee Keeping Honey Production
- Section B – 8. Mushroom Production
- Section B – 9. Aquaculture
- Section B – 10 to 19. Left blank to facilitate future enterprises
- Section B – 20. Processing Handling
- Section B – 21. Wine Making
- Section B – 22. Labelling
- Section B – 23. Social Justice
- Section B - Appendix 1, Input Evaluation
- Section B - Appendix 2. Fertilizers Conditioners
- Section B - Appendix 3. Protectants Regulators
- Section B - Appendix 4. Table 1 Processing Handling Additives Aids
- Section B - Appendix 4. Table 2 Processing Handling Cleaners Disinfectants

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- Section B - Appendix 5. Pest Disease Control Livestock Housing
- Section B - Appendix 6a. Livestock Number of Animals Equivalent to 170 Kg N per Ha per year
- Section B - Appendix 6b. Livestock Housing
- Section B - Appendix 7. Oenological
- Section C - Appendix A. SAOSO Organic Logos
- Section C - Appendix B. Criteria for Approval of PGS
- Section C - Appendix C. Procedure for Approval for Use of the South African Organic Sector Organisation (SAOSO) Organic PGS Endorsed

Each section contains subsections that are organized according to a similar structure, namely a statement of the general principle applicable to that section, followed by the requirements that have to be followed by the operators. The requirements are the minimum requirements that an operation, such as a farm or enterprise, must meet to be certified as organic.

The Standards do not cover game farming, medicinal products, cosmetics and textiles.

Technical terms are explained in the section on definitions below.

All exceptions are defined in the Standards and are "notifiable", i.e. they may only be implemented after the written notification / request to and approval of the Accredited Certification Body (ACB) or the PGS. They are reviewed annually.

Typically, the approval must be granted before the implementation thereof. The use of emergency veterinary treatments to ensure the welfare of animals and electric prodders are considered as operational exceptions, for which prior approval cannot necessarily be granted. Specific consequential action must be taken by the producer which includes notification to the ACB or PGS.

One criterion for the granting of an exception is that the producer must submit plans to overcome the circumstances leading to the application for the exception.

South African Guidance clauses are included where the Standards Committee were of the opinion that, given the relatively early stages of the development of some organic enterprises, such as livestock production, in South Africa and the corresponding lack of knowledge and experience, the IFOAM Norms may lead to misinterpretation and inconsistent decision making. These clauses are included to provide producers and certifiers with guidance in order to reach consistent, objective decisions.

5. NORMATIVE REFERENCES

The following referenced documents are indispensable for the publication of this document. For dated references, only the edition cited applies. For undated references, the latest edition of the referenced document (including any amendments) applies.

- *Codex general standard for food additives (GSFA).*
- *SANS 17065/ISO/IEC 17065, Conformity assessment – Requirements for bodies certifying products, processes and services.*
- *Appropriate South African Legislation*

6. APPROVAL, VERIFICATION AND EQUIVALENCE

6.1 Organic products sold in South Africa fall into one of four categories, all of which may use the South African Organic Sector Organisation (SAOSO) Organic logo (see Section C Appendix A) after an application

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in this regard has been lodged with SAOSO and approval to use the logo was granted by SAOSO. The four categories are the following:

a. Organic products produced in South Africa according to this standard and certified by a certification body holding a national or international accreditation with an organic scope and that carry the SAOSO Organic logo (see Section C Appendix A);

b. Organic products produced in South Africa according to these standards and approved as organic by members of participatory guarantee systems for local marketing which have been approved annually by SAOSO. These shall carry the SAOSO Organic PGS endorsed logo (see Section C Appendix A);

c. Organic products produced in South Africa and certified to other organic standards by a certification body holding a national or international accreditation with an organic scope, provided that the standard is listed as approved in the IFOAM "Family of Standards".

These shall bear marks that indicate organic certification. Producers shall provide copies of valid organic certificates to buyers when requested; or

d. Imported organic products certified to other organic standards, provided that:

1. The standard is listed as approved in the IFOAM "Family of Standards", and;

2. The product is certified under a certification program that is officially accepted under a government organic regulation or is certified by a certifier holding an international organic accreditation (accredited to ISO 17065 or SANS 17065, or IFOAM Accreditation) for the scope of the standard referred to above.

6.2 In the case of PGS market schemes, the PGS shall:

1. Align with this standard.

2. Provide evidence that the Criteria for Approval (Appendix 9) has been satisfied following the Procedures for Approval as stipulated by the relevant authority.

6.3 Imported organic products that are sold in their original, unaltered, foreign packaging and with marks indicating their certification status shall not require further certification. However, the importer shall be required to furnish copies of the original organic certificate and the transaction certificate associated with the transportation of the product to any buyer that requests it;

6.4 Imported products that are repackaged, relabelled or processed in any way after import shall require organic certification by an accredited certifier who shall ensure organic integrity and regulated chain of custody along the whole supply chain, starting from the original organic producer.

6.5 Any certification body certifying operators to the SAOSO Standard shall make publicly available, through print and or electronic media, a current list of operators certified against the SAOSO Standard, including at the very minimum their name, location, size of the area certified and the scope of the certification (plant production, animal production, wild collection, processing, etc.).

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SECTION A - 3

MINIMUM INSPECTION REQUIREMENTS AND PRECAUTIONARY MEASURES

Based on EU 2092/91, Annex III

NOTE: All cross references in this Section refer specifically to this Section.

1 GENERAL PROVISIONS

1.1. Minimum inspection requirements

1.1.1. The inspection requirements of this Section are necessary to ensure traceability of organic products during the entire production chain / chain of custody as referred to in the Standard and to ensure that the provisions of the standards are satisfied.

1.2. Initial inspection

1.2.1. When the inspection arrangements are first implemented, the operator responsible must fill in the application document, containing:

a A full description of the unit and / or premises and / or activity;

b. All the practical measures to be taken at the level of the unit and / or premises and / or activity to ensure compliance with the Standard and in particular with the requirements in this Section;

c Precautionary measure taken to reduce risk of contamination by cleaning measures or unauthorised products, such as in storage.

1.2.2. In addition, this signed declaration must include an undertaking by the operator:

a To perform operations in accordance with the Standards;

b To accept, in the event of infringement or irregularities, enforcement of the measures referred to in Item 1.8. below;

c In case of withdrawal or suspension of certification, to inform buyers in writing that all indications referring to organic production or to the ACB or PGS are removed from packaging;

d To accept, in cases where the operator and / or the subcontractors of that operator are checked by different ACB's and PGS' in accordance with the Standard and those which are members of the IFOAM Family of Standards, the exchange of information between those ACB's and PGS';

e To accept, in cases where the operator and / or the subcontractors of that operator change their ACB or PGS, the transmission of their control files to the subsequent ACB or PGS;

f To accept, in cases where the operator withdraws from the control system, to inform without delay the relevant ACB or PGS;

g To accept, in cases where the operator withdraws from the control system, that the control file is kept for a period of at least five years;

h To accept to inform the ACB or PGS management without delay of any irregularity or infringement affecting the organic status of their product or organic products received from other operators or subcontractors.

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This declaration must be verified by an ACB or PGS inspector in a report identifying the possible deficiencies and non-compliances with the provisions of the Standard. The operator must countersign this summary report and take the necessary corrective measures.

1.3. Communications

1.3.1. The operator must notify the ACB or PGS speedily of any change in the description of activities or of the practical measures referred to in point 1.2 above.

1.4. Inspection visits

1.4.1. Risk analysis: The ACB or PGS must make a full physical inspection, at least once a year, of the production / preparation units or other premises. However, in addition, there can be additional visits planned, either announced or unannounced, and there can be samples taken for laboratory analysis for pesticides and / or the presence or use of genetically modified organisms. There is an annual risk analysis carried out by the ACB or PGS management, and on the basis of the analysis, the annual intensity of supervision and control are drawn up. Thus:

a The result of the risk analysis provides the basis for determining the intensity of the unannounced or announced annual inspections and visits;

b Additional random control visits will be carried out of at least 10 % of operators under contract in accordance with the risk category are performed;

c At least 10 % of all inspections and visits carried out are unannounced;

d The selection of operators to be submitted to unannounced inspections and visits is determined on the basis of the risk analysis and that these are planned according to the level of risk.

1.4.2 Samples for laboratory analysis:

a The ACB or PGS shall take samples and have them analysed by a competent laboratory (ISO or equivalent accredited in the case of ACB certification) for detecting of products not authorised for organic production, for checking production techniques not in conformity with the organic production rules or for detecting possible contamination by products not authorised for organic production. The number of samples to be taken and analysed by the ACB or PGS management every year shall correspond to at least 5 % of the number of operators under its control. The selection of the operators where samples have to be taken shall be based on the general evaluation of the risk of non-compliance with the organic production rules. This general evaluation shall take into account all stages of production, preparation and distribution.

b The ACB or PGS shall take and analyse samples in each case where the use of products or techniques not authorised for organic production is suspected. In such cases no minimum number of samples to be taken and analysed shall apply.

c Samples may also be taken and analysed by the ACB or PGS in any other case for detecting of products not authorised for organic production, for checking production techniques not in conformity with the organic production rules or for detecting possible contamination by products not authorised for organic production.

1.5. Documentary accounts

1.5.1. Stock and financial records must be kept in the unit or premises, to enable the operator and the ACB or PGS to trace:

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a The supplier and, where different, the seller, or the exporter of the products;

b The nature and the quantities of all organic products delivered to the unit and, where relevant, of all materials bought and the use of such materials;

c The nature and quantities of all organic products held in storage at the premises;

d The nature, the quantities and the buyers of organic products which have left the unit;

e In the case of operators who do not store or physically handle such products, the nature and quantities of organic products bought and sold, and the suppliers, and where different, the sellers or the exporters and the buyers, and where different the consignees;

f The documentary accounts must also comprise the results of the verification at receipt of products and any other information required by the ACB or PGS for the purpose of proper inspection;

g The documentary accounts of bee-keepers will include the annual maps referred to in relevant Section of the Standards.

The data in the accounts must be documented with appropriate justification documents such as orders, waybills, delivery notes, invoices and receipt as appropriate.

The accounts must demonstrate the balance between the input and the output.

1.6. Packaging and transport of products to other production / preparation units or premises

1.6.1. The operators shall ensure that products referred to in the standards shall be transported to other units, including to wholesalers and retailers, only in appropriate packaging, containers or vehicles closed in such a manner that substitution of the content cannot be achieved without manipulation or damage of the seal and provided with a label stating, without prejudice to any other indications required by law:

a The name and address of the operator and, where different, of the owner or seller of the product;

b The name of the product, including a reference to the organic production method, in accordance with Section B – 22 of the Standards below;

c The ACB or PGS name and logo;

d Where relevant, the lot identification mark according to a marking system either approved at national level or agreed with the ACB or PGS and which permits to undeniably link the lot with the accounts referred to in Section 1.5. above;

e The information under point 1.6.1 a, b, c and d can also be presented on an accompanying document, if such document can be undeniably linked with the packaging, container or vehicle of the product. This accompanying document shall include information on the supplier and / or the transporter.

1.6.2. However, the closing of packaging, containers or vehicles is not required where:

a Transportation is direct between a producer and another operator who are both subject to the inspection system referred to in this Standards;

b The products are accompanied by a document giving the information required under the previous subparagraph;

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c The ACB or PGS of both the sending and the receiving operators have been informed of such transport operations and have agreed thereto. Such agreement might be provided for one or more transport operation(s).

1.7. Storage of products

1.7.1. For the storage of products, areas must be managed in order to ensure identification of lots and to avoid any mixing with or contamination by products and / or substances not in compliance with the standards.

1.8. Products suspected not to satisfy the requirements of the Standards

1.8.1 Where an operator considers or suspects that a product which he has produced, prepared, imported or been delivered from another operator, is not in compliance with the standards he shall initiate procedures either to withdraw from this product any reference to the organic production method or to separate and identify the product. He only may put it into processing or packaging or on the market after elimination of that doubt, unless it is placed on the market without indication referring to the organic production method. In case of such doubt, the operator shall immediately inform their ACB or PGS. The ACB or PGS may require that the product cannot be placed on the market with indications referring to the organic production method until it is satisfied, by the information received from the operator or from other sources, that the doubt has been eliminated.

1.8.2. Where an ACB or PGS has a substantiated suspicion that an operator intends to place on the market a product not in compliance with the Standard but bearing a reference to the organic production method, the ACB or PGS can require that the operator may provisionally not market the product with this reference. This decision shall be supplemented by the obligation to withdraw from this product any reference to the organic production method if the ACB or PGS is sure that the product does not fulfil the requirements of the Standard. However, if the suspicion is not confirmed, the above decision shall be cancelled not later than a time period after having been taken. The ACB or PGS shall define this time period. The operator shall co-operate fully with the ACB or PGS in resolving the suspicion.

1.9. Access to facilities

1.9.1. The operator must give the ACB or PGS, for inspection purposes, access to all parts of the unit and all premises, as well as to the accounts and relevant supporting documents. He must provide the ACB or PGS with any information deemed necessary for the purposes of the inspection.

1.9.2. When requested by the ACB or PGS, the operator shall submit the results of its own voluntary inspection and sampling programmes.

1.9.3. In addition, importers must submit any transaction certificates for imports from third countries.

1.10. Exchange of information

1.10.1. Where the operator and his subcontractors are inspected by different ACB's or PGS', the declaration referred to in point 1.2 must include an agreement by the operator on his behalf and that of his subcontractors, that the different ACB's or PGS' can exchange information on the operations under their inspection and on the way this exchange of information can be implemented.

2. SPECIFIC PROVISIONS

2.1. Production of plants, plant products, livestock and / or livestock products.

2.1.1. This section applies to any unit involved in production of products as defined or referred to in the Standard for its own account or for account of a third party.

2.1.2. Production must take place in a unit of which the production premises, land parcels, pasturage, open-air exercise areas, open air runs, livestock buildings, and, where applicable, the premises for the storage of crops,

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crop products, livestock products, raw materials and inputs, are clearly separate from those of any other unit not producing in accordance with the rules laid down in the Standard.

2.1.3. Processing, packaging and / or marketing may take place at the production unit, where these activities are limited to its own agricultural produce.

2.1.4. Quantities sold directly to the final consumer shall be accounted on a daily basis.

2.1.5. Storage, in the unit, of input products other than those permitted by the Standard is prohibited.

2.1.6 On receipt of a product certified in terms of the Standard, the operator shall check the closing of the packaging or container where it is required and the presence of the indications referred to in point 1.6 above. The result of this verification shall be written in the documentary accounts referred to in point 1.5 above.

2.2. Plants and plant products from farm production or collection

2.2.1. Initial inspection: The full description of the unit referred to under point 1.2 above must:

a Be drawn up even where the producer limits his activity to the collection of wild plants;

b Show the storage and production premises and land parcels and / or collection areas and, where applicable, premises where certain processing and / or packaging operations take place and

c Specify the date of the last application on the parcels and / or collection areas concerned of any products not permitted in organic agriculture.

d In the case of collection of wild plants, the practical measures referred to under point 1.2 above must include the guarantees given by third parties which the producer can provide to ensure that the provisions of Section B - 6.1. of the Standard are complied with.

2.2.2. Communications: Each year, before the date indicated by the ACB or PGS, the producer must notify the ACB or PGS of his schedule of production of crop products, giving a breakdown by parcel.

2.2.3. Several production units run by the same operator: Where an operator runs several production units in the same area, the units producing crops or crop products not certified in terms of the Standard together with storage premises for input products (such as fertilisers, plant protection products, seed) must also be subject to the General Provisions as described above in point 2.1 as well as to the specific inspections described here.

2.2.4. The same variety as, or a variety that cannot be easily distinguished from those produced at the unit and certified according to this Standard may not be produced at these units.

2.2.5. However, producers may deviate from the provision of point 2.2.4 under the following circumstances:

a In the case of the production of perennial crops provided the following conditions are met:

i The production in question forms part of a conversion plan in respect of which the producer gives a firm undertaking and which provides for the beginning of the conversion of the last part of the area concerned to organic production in the shortest possible period which may not in any event exceed a maximum of five years;

ii Appropriate measures have been taken to ensure the permanent separation of the products obtained from each unit concerned;

iii The ACB or PGS is notified of the harvest of each of the products concerned at least 48 hours in advance;

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iv Immediately upon completion of the harvest, the producer informs the ACB or PGS of the exact quantities harvested on the units concerned together with any particular distinguishing features (such as quality, colour, average weight, etc.) and confirms that the measures taken to separate the products have been applied;

v The conversion plan and the clearance of non-conformities following each annual inspection have been approved by the ACB or PGS. This approval must be confirmed each year after the start of the conversion plan.

b In the case of areas intended for agricultural research conducted by a registered research organisation;

c In the case of production of seed, vegetative propagating material and transplants, provided that conditions of points 2.2.5. a.ii, a.iii and a.iv and the relevant part of condition a.v above are met.;

d In the case of grassland exclusively used for grazing.

2.3. Livestock and livestock products produced by animal husbandry

2.3.1. Initial inspection: When the inspection system applying specifically to livestock production is first implemented, the full description of the unit referred to under point 1.2 above must include:

a A full description of the livestock buildings, pasturage, open-air exercise areas, open air runs, etc., and, where applicable, the premises for the storage, packaging and processing of livestock, livestock products, raw materials and inputs,

b A full description of the installations for the storage of livestock manure.

2.3.2. The practical measures referred to under point 1.2 must include:

a Plan for spreading manure agreed with the ACB or PGS, together with a full description of the areas given over to crop production,

b Where appropriate, as regards the spreading of manure, the written arrangements with other holdings complying with the provisions of the Standard.

c A management plan for the organic-production livestock unit (e.g. management for feeding, reproduction, health, etc.).

2.3.2. Identification of livestock: The livestock must be identified permanently using techniques adapted to each species, individually in the case of large mammals and individually or by batch in the case of poultry and small mammals.

2.3.3. Livestock records: Livestock records must be compiled in the form of a register and kept available to the inspection ACB or PGS at all times at the address of the holding. Such records, which are to provide a full description of the herd or flock management system, must contain the following information:

a By species, as regards livestock arriving at the holding: origin and date of arrival, conversion period, identification mark and veterinary record;

b As regards livestock leaving the holding: age, number of heads, weight in case of slaughter, identification mark and destination;

c Details of any animals lost and reasons;

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d As regards feed: type, including feed supplements, proportions of various ingredients of rations and periods of access to free-range areas, periods of transhumance where restrictions apply;

e As regards disease prevention and treatment and veterinary care: date of treatment, diagnosis, type of treatment product, method of treatment and practitioner's prescription for veterinary care with reasons and withdrawal periods applying before livestock products can be marketed.

2.3.4. Several production units run by the same operator:

a Where a producer manages several production units, with some units which produce livestock (including bees) or livestock products not certified in terms of the Standard, all the production units, both organic and conventional, must be subject to the inspection system as in point 2.1 above and as regards the provisions on livestock management, livestock records and the principles governing storage of animal husbandry products used.

b An exception with regard to the requirement for different and distinguishable involved species on the same farm in Section B – 5 below of the Standard may be granted to holdings carrying out agricultural research by the ACB or PGS in agreement with the South African competent authority, where the following conditions are met:

i Appropriate measures, agreed with the ACB or PGS have been taken in order to guarantee the permanent separation between livestock, livestock products, manure and feeding stuffs of each of the units;

ii The producer informs the ACB or PGS in advance of any delivery or selling of the livestock livestock products;

iii The operator informs the ACB or PGS of the exact quantities produced in the units together with all characteristics permitting the identification of the products and confirms that the measures taken to separate the products have been applied.

2.3.5. Other requirements: By way of an exception to these rules, the storage of allopathic veterinary medicinal products and antibiotics is permitted on holdings provided that they have been prescribed by a veterinarian in connection with treatment as referred to in the Standard that they are stored in a supervised location and that they are entered in the farm register.

3. UNITS FOR PREPARATION OF PLANT AND LIVESTOCK PRODUCTS AND FOODSTUFFS COMPOSED OF PLANT AND LIVESTOCK PRODUCTS

This section applies to any unit involved in the preparation of products certified in terms of the Standard for its own account or for account of a third party, and including in particular also:

a Units involved in packaging and / or re-packaging of such products;

b Units involved in labelling and / or re-labelling of such products.

3.1. Initial inspection

3.1.1. The full description of the unit referred to under point 2.1 above must show the facilities used for the reception, the processing, packaging, labelling and storage of agricultural products before and after the operations concerning them, as well as the procedures for the transport of the products.

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3.2. Preparation units handling also products not from organic production

3.2.1. Where products not certified in terms of the Standard are also prepared, packaged or stored in the preparation unit concerned:

a The unit must have areas separated by place or time within the premises for the storage of products certified in terms of the Standard before and after the operations,

b Operations must be carried out continuously until the complete run has been dealt with, separated by place or time from similar operations performed on products not certified in terms of the Standard,

c If such operations are not carried out at regular times or on a fixed day, they must be announced in advance, with a deadline agreed on with the ACB or PGS,

d Every measure must be taken to ensure identification of lots and to avoid mixtures or exchanges with products not obtained in accordance with the rules laid down in the Standard,

e Operations on products which meet the rules laid down in the Standard must be carried out only after cleaning of the production equipment. The effectiveness of the cleaning measures must be checked and recorded.

3.3. Packaging and transport of products to preparation units

3.3.1. Milk, eggs and egg-products from organic farming shall be collected independently from products not produced in accordance with the Standard. By exception, and subject to the prior approval by the ACB or PGS, simultaneous collection may occur, where appropriate measures are taken to prevent any possible mixture or exchange with products not produced in accordance with the Standard and to ensure the identification of the products produced in accordance with the provisions of the Standard. The operator shall keep the information relating to collection days, hours, circuit and date and time of reception of the products and make this information available to the ACB or PGS.

4. IMPORTS OF PLANTS, PLANT PRODUCTS, LIVESTOCK, LIVESTOCK PRODUCTS AND FOODSTUFFS COMPOSED OF PLANT PRODUCTS AND/OR LIVESTOCK PRODUCTS FROM THIRD COUNTRIES

Products imported by operators certified to these standards shall be imported from a third country in appropriate packaging or containers, closed in a manner preventing substitution of the content and provided with identification of the exporter and with any other marks and numbers serving to identify the lot with the certificate of inspection for import from third countries.

On receipt of an organic product imported from a third country, the importer shall check the closing of the packaging or container and the correspondence of the identification of the consignment with its organic certificate. The result of this verification shall be written down and made available to the ACB or PGS.

4.1 Imported organic products shall be accepted by the ACB or PGS as valid provided that:

4.1.1. An organic certificate has first been obtained and approved by the ACB or PGS as:

a Having been provided by an accredited certifier that meets SAOSO's criteria for equivalence;

b Within the appropriate expiry date of the certificate.

4.1.2. Packaging, labels, lot / batch number, waybill, and properly marked invoice clearly link the specific import to the organic certificate previously obtained, preferably with a transaction certificate also provided by the

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exporter's certifier. Such documents should be kept until the next organic inspection (or may be forwarded earlier to the ACB or PGS if so requested) and indicate:

a The name and address of the exporter and importer;

b The contents of the package, including that they are certified organic ;

c The lot / batch number;

d The name of the certifier;

e The weight of the package.

4.2 Importers and first consignees also handling products not from organic production

4.2.1. When imported products are stored in storage facilities where other agricultural products or foodstuffs are also stored:

a The organic products must be kept separate from the other agricultural products and / or foodstuffs;

b Every measure must be taken to ensure identification of consignments and to avoid mixtures or exchanges with products not obtained in accordance with the rules laid down in this Standard.

4.3 Inspection visits

4.3.1. The ACB or PGS shall inspect the stock and financial records of the importer, including the documents associated with each import, and the organic certificates of the exporter.

4.3.2. Where an importer performs the import operations for one or more organic operations, he must make available on request, the documentation for each of the import consignments for each organic operator.

5. UNITS INVOLVED IN THE PRODUCTION, PREPARATION OR IMPORT OF PRODUCTS WHICH HAVE CONTRACTED OUT TO THIRD PARTIES IN PART OR IN TOTAL THE ACTUAL OPERATIONS CONCERNED

5.1. Initial inspection

5.1.1. With regard to the operations, which are contracted out to third parties, the full description referred to in point 2.1 above shall include:

a A list of the subcontractors with a description of their activities and the ACB's or PGS' to which they are subject; these subcontractors must have agreed to have their holding being subject to an inspection by the ACB or PGS, in accordance with the relevant sections of this annexure;

b All the practical measures, including inter alia an appropriate system of documentary accounts, to be taken at the level of the unit to ensure that the products the operator places on the market can be traced to their suppliers, and, where different, their sellers, as well as to their consignees and, where different, their buyers;

c The contracted party shall be inspected by the ACB or PGS before the use of the contracted product or service. Subsequent inspections shall be made annually or at a frequency determined on a case-by-case basis providing that the ACB or PGS documents the reasons for the reduced frequency.

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6. UNITS PREPARING ANIMAL FEED, COMPOUND FEED AND FEED MATERIALS

This section applies to any unit involved in the preparing animal feed, compound feed and feed materials on its own account or on behalf of a third party.

Feed may only be termed as suitable for organic livestock, and labelled or advertised as such, if all ingredients of plant or animal origin are from the organic production method and at least 95 % of the product's dry matter is comprised of such ingredients.

6.1. Initial inspection

6.1.1 The full description of the unit must:

a Indicate the facilities used for the reception, preparation and storage of the products intended for animal feed before and after the operations concerning them;

b Indicate the facilities used for the storage of other products used to prepare feed;

c Indicate the facilities used to store products for cleaning and disinfection;

d Indicate, where necessary, the description of the compound feed that the operator intends to produce, and the livestock species or class for which the compound feed is intended;

e Indicate, where necessary, the name of the feed materials that the operator intends to prepare.

6.1.2. The measures to be taken by operators to guarantee compliance with this Standard must include:

a In particular an indication of the precautionary measures to be taken in order to reduce the risk of contamination by unauthorised substances or products, the cleaning measures impl;mented and the monitoring of their effectiveness;

b Identification of all elements of their activities crucial for guaranteeing at all times that the products referred to in Section 5.5.8 below are prepared in such units which comply with this Standard;

c The establishment and implementation of, compliance with and updating of appropriate procedures, based on the principles of the HACCP (Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points) system.

The ACB or PGS shall use these procedures to carry out a general evaluation of the risks attendant on each preparation unit and to draw up an inspection plan. This inspection plan must provide for a minimum number of random samples depending on the potential risks.

6.2. Documentary accounts

6.2.1. For the purposes of proper inspection of the operations, the documentary accounts referred to in point 1.5 above shall include information on the origin, nature and quantities of feed materials, additives, sales and finished products.

6.3. Preparation units

6.3.1. When preparing products, operators must ensure that:

a Organically produced feed or feed derived therefrom, in-conversion feed or feed derived therefrom, and conventional feed are effectively physically separated;

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b All equipment used in units preparing compound feed covered by this Standard is completely separated from equipment used for compound feed not covered by this Standard.

6.4. Inspection visits

6.4.1. In addition to the complete annual visit, the ACB or PGS must make targeted visits based on a general evaluation of the potential risks of non-compliance with this Standard; the ACB or PGS shall pay particular attention to the critical control points pointed out for the operator, with a view to establishing whether the surveillance and checking operations are carried out as they should be. All the premises used by the operator for the conduct of his activities may be inspected as frequently as the attendant risks warrant.

6.5. Transporting products to other production / preparation units or storage premises

6.5.1. Operators must ensure that the following conditions are met:

a During transport, organically-produced feed or feed derived therefrom, in-conversion feed or feed derived therefrom, and conventional feed must be effectively physically separated;

b The vehicles and / or containers which have transported products that are not covered by this Standard may be used to transport products covered by this Standard if:

i Suitable cleaning measures, the effectiveness of which has been checked, have been carried out before commencing the transport of products covered by this Standard; operators must record these operations;

ii Operators must ensure that all appropriate m;easures are implemented, depending on the risks evaluated in accordance with point 6.5.1 above, and, where necessary, guarantee that products /which do not conform to this Standard cannot be placed on the market with an indication referring to organic farming;

iii The ACB or PGS of the operator has been informed of such transport operations and has agreed thereto. Such agreement might be provided for one or more transport operation(s);

c The finished products referred to in this Standard are transported separately from other finished products physically or in time;

d During transport, the quantity of products at the start and each individual quantity delivered in the course of a delivery round must be recorded.

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SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

1. DEFINITIONS

ACB

Accredited Certification Body. Accredited to ISO 17065, SANS 17065 or international equivalent.

Acceptable

Acceptable to the authority administering this Standard, or to the parties concluding the purchase contract, as relevant, in such a way that the intended purpose of this Standard is achieved.

Accredited

Officially recognized in accordance with acceptable standards.

Additive

A substance that is not normally consumed as a food by itself and that is not normally used as a typical ingredient of the food, whether or not it has nutritive value. An additive is an intentional addition of the substance to food for a technological (including organoleptic) purpose in the manufacture, processing, preparation, treatment, packing, packaging, transport or holding of such food. This results, or may be reasonably expected to result either directly or indirectly, in the additive or its by-products becoming a component of the food or otherwise may affect the characteristic of the food.

NOTE An additive does not include contaminants, or substances that are added to food for maintaining or improving the nutritional qualities of the food. Sodium chloride is not an additive.

Amino acid isolate

Amino acid substance (e.g. methionine, lysine, threonine) that has been isolated or extracted to a more pure form than occurs in the parent material (e.g. soy, corn, etc).

Aquaculture

The managed production of aquatic plants and / or animals in fresh, brackish or salt water in a circumscribed (demarcated) environment.

Aquaponics / Hydroponic Systems / Hydroponic Production

Aquaponics combines hydroponic and aquaculture practices into one production system. Production systems in inert media (perlite, gravel, mineral wool, other) and / or water solutions using dissociated nutrients (in suspension or solution) as prime source of nutrient supply are not permitted under this Standard as the plant roots are not in soil.

South African specific
Audit / Assessment
Systematic and functionally independent examination that is conducted to determine whether activities and related results comply with planned objectives. Audit refers to third party and assessment to Participatory Guarantee Systems (PGS).

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Ayurvedic

Traditional Indian system of medicine.

Biodiversity

The variety of life forms and ecosystem types on Earth. Includes genetic diversity (i.e. diversity within species), species diversity (i.e. the number and variety of species) and ecosystem diversity (total number of ecosystem types), as well as the dynamic effects they engender.

South African specific
Biodynamic
Biodynamic agriculture is a holistic method of natural farming that works with cosmic and earthly rhythms and where plants and animals are integrated and biodiversity is encouraged. Demeter is the trademark for certified biodynamic agriculture which follows strictly the standard of the Biodynamic Federation Demeter International

Breeding

Selection of plants or animals to reproduce and / or to further develop desired characteristics in succeeding generations.

Buffer Zone

A clearly defined and identifiable boundary area bordering an organic production site that is established to limit application of, or contact with, prohibited substances from an adjacent area.

South African specific
Certification
Procedure that is employed by Accredited Certification Bodies and Participatory Guarantee Systems approved by PGS-South Africa (PGS-SA) to provide written or equivalent assurance that a product, process or service complies with acceptable standards.

Certification Body

The body, accredited to SANS 17065 or equivalent, or in the case of PGS initiatives, recognised by PGS-SA, that conducts (grants) certification, as distinct from standard setting and inspection.

Compost

Decomposed and humified organic material used as a soil fertility amendment in agricultural production, produced by a combination of actions over time by microbes, invertebrates, temperature, and other elemental factors (e.g., moisture content, aeration).

Contamination

Adulteration of organic product or land with a substance prohibited for organic production or handling.

Control Body

An organization that has independent oversight of the organic status of an operation. A Control Body may be an accredited certification body, a governmental competent authority, in the case of PGS initiatives, PGS South Africa, a cooperative, or a community supported agriculture program

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Conventional

In the context of this Standard, conventional means any production or processing practice, or material, that is not organic or organic "in-conversion".

Conversion Period

The time between the start of the organic management and the acceptance of crops and animal husbandry as organic.

Crop Rotation

The practice of alternating the species or families of annual and / or biennial crops grown on a specific field in a planned pattern or sequence to break weed, pest and disease cycles and to maintain or improve soil fertility and organic matter content.

Cover Crop / Green Manure

A crop that is specifically grown and either crimped or incorporated into the soil for the purpose of soil improvement. This may include spontaneous crops, plants or weeds.

Culture

Microorganisms, tissue, or organ, growing on or in a medium and substrate.

Direct Source Organism

The specific plant, animal, or microbe that produces a given input or ingredient.

Disinfect

To reduce, by physical or chemical means, the number of potentially harmful microorganisms in the environment, to a level that does not compromise product safety or suitability.

South African specific
Extensive Farming
Farming that corresponds to at least the stocking densities as indicated in these standards and includes the prescribed outdoor area requirements for the animals the number of animals per ha corresponding to 170 kg of Nitrogen per year/hectare as defined in the Standard and provided that other animals which are subject to the requirements of this Standard are not present on this pasturage at the same time. See Appendix 6a and 6b of this Standard for these requirements.
Intensive Farming
Those practices that do not fit within the "factory farming" or "extensive farming" definitions.
Factory farming
Industrial management systems that are heavily reliant on veterinary and feed inputs not permitted in organic agriculture and / or where the animals are hindered from moving freely around 360°, or kept in isolation or deprived from litter and thus include animals kept in batteries or fattening of chickens with more than 25kg weight/m^2.

Farm Unit

The total area of land under control of one farmer or a collective of farmers, including all the farming activities or enterprises.

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Genetic Diversity

The variability among living organisms from agricultural, forest and aquatic ecosystems; this includes diversity within species and between species.

Genetic Engineering

A set of techniques from molecular biology (such as recombinant DNA) by which the genetic material of plants, animals, microorganisms, cells and other biological units are altered in ways or with results that could not be obtained by methods of natural mating and reproduction or natural recombination. Techniques of genetic engineering include, but are not limited to recombinant DNA, cell fusion, micro- and macro-injection, and encapsulation. Genetically engineered organisms do not include organisms resulting from techniques such as conjugation, transduction and natural hybridization.

Genetically Modified Organism (GMO)

Organism that is produced through techniques in which the genetic material has been altered in a way that does not occur naturally by mating or through natural recombination, or through both means.

Genetic Resources

Genetic material of actual or potential value.

Habitat

The area over which a plant or animal species naturally exists; the area where a species occurs. Also used to indicate types of habitat, e.g. seashore, riverbank, woodland, grassland.

High Conservation Value Area

An area that has been identified as having outstanding and critical importance due to its environmental, socioeconomic, biodiversity or landscape values.

Homeopathic Treatment

Treatment of disease based on administration of remedies prepared through successive dilutions of a substance that in larger amounts produces symptoms in healthy subjects similar to those of the disease itself.

Ingredient

Any substance including a food additive that is used in the manufacture or preparation of a food, or that is present in the final product, although possibly in a modified form.

Irradiation / ionizing radiation / radurisation

High energy emissions from radio-nucleotides, capable of altering a product's molecular structure for the purpose of controlling microbial contaminants, pathogens, parasites and pests in food, preserving food or inhibiting physiological processes such as sprouting or ripening, or for the purpose of inducing mutations for selection and breeding.

Label

Any written, printed or graphic representation that is present on a product, accompanies the product, or is displayed near the product.

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South African specific
Labelling
Applying written, printed or graphic representation, particulars, information, trademark, brand name, pictorial matter or symbol to a label, container, packaging, document, notice board or collar of a product, that accompanies the product or that is displayed near the product, for the purpose of describing or promoting the sale or disposal of the product.

Landless animal husbandry systems

Systems by which the operator of the livestock does not manage agricultural land and / or has not established a long-term cooperation agreement with another operator organically managing agricultural land, whether it be for pasture, supply of feed or disposal of manure & effluent.

South African specific
Logo
Special symbol or other small design that is used by an accredited certification body

Manure

All livestock excrement that may be mixed with litter material.

Media (plural) or Medium (singular)

The substance in which an organism, tissue, or organ exists, which includes the substrate.

Multiplication

The growing on of seed stock or plant material to increase supply for future planting.

Nanomaterials

Substances deliberately designed, engineered and produced by human activity to be in the nanoscale range (approx 1-300 nm) because of very specific properties or compositions (e.g. shape, surface properties, or chemistry) that result only in that nanoscale. These materials are specifically excluded from the standard.

Incidental particles in the nanoscale range created during traditional food processing such as homogenization, milling, churning, and freezing, and naturally occurring particles in the nanoscale range are not intended to be included in this definition. These materials are permitted in this Standard.

South African specific
Notifiable exception
An exception to a requirement stipulated in this Standard, which is allowed once the relevant certifying authority is notified and has given authorisation for the said exception to apply. Exceptions might have conditions specified in the standard or annexes.

South African specific
Nulliparous
A female that has not borne offspring.

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Organic agriculture

Organic agriculture is a production system that sustains the health of soils, ecosystems and people. It relies on ecological processes, biodiversity and cycles adapted to local conditions. Organic agriculture combines tradition, innovation and science to benefit the shared environment and promote fair relationships and a good quality of life for all involved.

South African specific
Organic fertilizer
A fertilizer which complies to the requirements of this Standard and if necessary has been approved and labelled as an approved input into organic agriculture. NOTE: Fertilizers labelled as "organic" under Act 36 of 1947 are not necessarily organic according to this Standard.

Organic Product

A product that has been produced, processed, and / or handled in compliance with organic standards.

Organic Seed and Plant Material

Seed and planting material that is produced under certified organic management.

South African specific
In-conversion
Descriptive of a production system that has met the requirements of this Standard for at least one year and has been certified as such, and applies to plants and plant products only, but that does not qualify as fully organic.

Parallel Production

Any production where the same unit is growing, breeding, handling or processing the same products in an organic system and in a non-organic system. A situation with "organic" and "in-conversion" production of the same product is also parallel production. Parallel production is a special instance of split production. Parallel production is a special type of split production (see below).

South African specific	
Participatory Guarantee System / Participatory Guarantee Scheme / PGS	
Second-party certification system among a group of collaborating producers who produce products for a local market, as follows:	
a	The system shares a common objective with third-party certification systems that are run by accredited certification bodies by providing a credible guarantee to consumers who seek organic products;
b	Participatory Guarantee Systems (PGS) are locally focused quality assurance systems. They certify producers based on active participation of stakeholders and are built on a foundation of trust, social networks and knowledge exchange.
c	The system is especially adapted to local markets and short supply chains.
d	PGSs enable the direct participation of producers, consumers and other stakeholders in the development and implementation of verification procedures and the review and decision process that is followed to recognize farmers as producers of organic food.
e	The system allows a much more intensive interaction between the producer and the guarantee organization, and uses tools other than those that are used by third-party certification bodies to maintain integrity

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f	PGSs integrate capacity building and allow producers and reviewers to help solve practical problems that will enable producers to comply with the standards.
g	The direct involvement of producers in the PGS process, and the fact that the process is owned by them and other stakeholders, encourage the farmers to take on more responsibility and results in their active involvement in the design of production and certification processes.

South African specific
Primary Forest
Indigenous forest (including bushveld type trees) that does not indicate bush encroachment or is not a consequence thereof.

South African specific
Processing / Processed
Descriptive of cooking, baking, heating, drying, mixing, crushing, pressing, churning, separating, extracting juices or other material, peeling, fermenting, eviscerating, preserving, dehydrating, freezing or manufacturing that materially alters the flavour, keeps the quality, or any other property or the making of any substantial change of form, but that does not include refrigeration at temperatures which are above freezing point or any other treatment that merely delays or accelerates the natural processes of ripening or disintegration.

Processing Aid

Any substance or material, not including apparatus or utensils, and not consumed as a product ingredient by itself, intentionally used in the processing of raw materials, the product or its ingredients, to fulfil a certain technical purpose during treatment or processing and which may result in the non-intentional but unavoidable presence of residues or derivatives in the final product. This includes filtration auxiliaries and solvents used for extraction.

South African specific
Producer
Person or business enterprise that is involved at any stage of the production, processing, storage, packaging, display and importation of organic or organic in-conversion products, or who markets such products. In the context of this Standard the term “producer” is used generically for all farmers and those involved with processing.

Propagation

The reproduction of plants by sexual (i.e. seed) or asexual (i.e. cuttings, root division) means.

Protected Cropping

The growing of crops under forms of constructed or man-made protection such as greenhouses, polytunnels, plastic roofs, nets, fleece, or cloches.

Ruderal

Of a plant. Growing in waste places, along roadsides or in rubbish.

Sanitize

To adequately treat produce or product-contact surfaces by a process that is effective in destroying or substantially reducing the numbers of vegetative cells of microorganisms of public health concern, and other undesirable microorganisms, but without adversely affecting the product or its safety for the consumer.

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Soil

Soil is the natural living ecosystem that develops on the surface of the earth as a result of the influence of climate, topography, biological activity, time, and sometimes cultivation, on the mineral parent material. Soil is composed of air, water, minerals, organisms and organic matter and is connected to the outermost layer of the earth.

Soil fertility

The potential capacity of the soil to supply nutrients required for plant growth.

Soil fertility is dependent on soil health which is in turn dependent on soil quality.

Soil health

Soil health is the continued capacity of the soil to function as a vital living system, within ecosystem and land use boundaries, to sustain biological productivity, maintain the quality of air and water environments, and promote plant, animal and human health. Soil health is the ability of soil to perform according to its potential and changes over time due to human use and management or to natural events.

Soil quality

Soil quality is the functional capacity of the soil, within ecosystem and land-use boundaries, to sustain biological productivity, maintain environmental quality and promote plant, animal, microbial and human health. Soil quality is a function of its biological, physical and chemical properties, many of which are a function of soil organic matter content, which influence the capacity of soil to perform crop production and environmental functions, including the absence of contaminants.

Split Production

Where only part of the farm or processing unit is organic. The remainder of the property can be (a) non-organic, and / or (b) in-conversion. Also see parallel production.

Substrate

The substance that an organism grows in and lives upon.

Synthetic

A substance that is formulated or manufactured by a chemical process or by a process that chemically changes a substance extracted from a naturally occurring plant, animal or mineral source

Thermal sterilization

Non-selective heat treatment of the soil to differing depths to kill soil fauna and flora.

South African specific
Wild Harvesting / Wild Harvested / Wild Crafted
Collecting products according to the requirements of these standards that are not cultivated, but that are found growing naturally in the wild.

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SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

2. ORGANIC ECOSYSTEMS

2.1 Ecosystem Management

General Principle

Organic farming benefits the quality of ecosystems.

Requirements

2.1.1 Operators shall design and implement measures to maintain and improve landscape and enhance biodiversity quality, by maintaining on-farm wildlife refuge habitats or establishing them where none exist. Such habitats may include, but are not limited to:

a Extensive grassland such as moorlands, reed land or dry land;

b In general, all areas which are not under rotation and are not heavily manured: extensive pastures, meadows, extensive grassland, extensive orchards, hedges, hedgerows, edges between agriculture and forest land, groups of trees and / or bushes, and forest and woodland;

c Ecologically rich fallow land or arable land;

d ecologically diversified (extensive) field margins;

e Waterways, pools, springs, ditches, floodplains, wetlands, swamps and other water-rich areas which are not used for intensive agriculture or aquaculture production;

f Areas with ruderal flora;

g Wildlife corridors that provide linkages and connectivity to native habitat.

2.1.2 Clearing or destruction of High Conservation Value Areas is prohibited.

Farming areas installed on land that has been obtained by clearing of High Conservation Value Areas in the preceding 5 years shall not be considered compliant with this Standard.

2.1.3. Clearing of virgin forest: The clearance of virgin forest for agricultural usage is forbidden. Other high value conservation areas must also be protected, and may only be cleared according to appropriate legislation;

2.1.4. Biodiversity reserve: The farm must show a commitment to the maintenance of farm biodiversity. If the Biodiversity reserve on the farm and in areas directly adjacent to it does not reach 10% of the total farm area, a biodiversity plan that documents how this will be achieved, with a clear time frame, must be approved by the respective organization. This plan can include other cultural elements such as the maintenance of rare or endangered breeds of plants and animals, fostering bird/insect life by providing habitats.

South African specific	
Areas considered as virgin and as Biodiversity Reserves are as defined in the:	
a	*Act 43 of 1983 Conservation of Agricultural Resources as amended.*
b	*Act 57 of 2003 National Environmental Management Protected Areas as amended.*
c	*Act 84 of 1998 National Forests Act as amended.*

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a Lightly grazed fields that allow for some vegetation to flower and go to seed;

b Forested fields (agro forestry);

c Undisturbed forest;

d Headlands;

e Land seeded to annual / perennial plants that are allowed to go through flowering;

f Fallow land as part of the rotation or otherwise;

g Undisturbed grasslands (no mowing in the courses of a year);

h Fence lines (width of undisturbed land can be counted);

I Indigenous and endemic trees, single trees appropriate to the location (100m2 per tree) and tree lined avenues;

j Hedges, field and stream bank tree groves;

k Water bodies, races, ponds, wetlands, riparian areas;

l Ruderal areas (e.g., landslips), stone windrows and heaps;

m Dry stone walls;

n Unsealed natural paths and tracks;

o Other biodiversity reserve contribution, including husbandry of rare or endangered plant and animal species;

p Other element approved in the Biodiversity plan.

2.2. Soil and Water Conservation

General Principle

Organic farming methods conserve and improve the soil, maintain water quality and use water efficiently and responsibly.

Requirements

2.2.1. Operators shall take defined and appropriate measures to prevent erosion and minimize loss of topsoil. Such measures may include, but are not limited to: minimal tillage, contour ploughing, crop selection, maintenance of soil plant cover and other management practices that conserve soil.

2.2.2. Land preparation by burning vegetation or crop residues is prohibited.

Regional or other exception
Exceptions may be granted in cases where burning is used to suppress the spread of disease, to stimulate seed germination, to remove intractable residues, or other such exceptional cases.

2.2.3. Operators shall return nutrients, organic matter and other resources removed from the soil through harvesting by the recycling, regeneration and addition of organic materials and nutrients.

2.2.4. Stocking densities and grazing shall not degrade land or pollute water resources. This applies also to all manure management and applications.

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2.2.5. Operators shall prevent or remedy soil and water salinization where these pose a problem.

2.2.6. Operators shall not deplete nor excessively exploit water resources and shall seek to preserve water quality. They shall where possible recycle rainwater and monitor water extraction.

2.3. Inappropriate technologies

General Principle

Organic agriculture and aquaculture are based on the precautionary principle and should prevent significant risks by adopting appropriate technologies and rejecting unpredictable ones.

Requirements

2.3.1. The deliberate use or negligent introduction of genetically engineered organisms or their derivatives is prohibited. This shall include animals, seed, propagation material, feed, and farm inputs such as fertilizers, soil conditioners, or crop protection materials, but shall exclude vaccines.

2.3.2. Organic operators shall not use ingredient, additives or processing aids derived from GMOs.

2.3.3. Inputs, processing aids and ingredients shall be traced back one step in the biological chain to the direct source organism from which they are produced to verify that they are not derived from GMOs.

2.3.4. On farms with split (including parallel) production, the use of genetically engineered organisms is not permitted in any production activity on the farm.

2.3.5. The use of nanomaterials is prohibited in organic production and processing, including in packaging and product contact surfaces. No substance allowed under this Standard shall be allowed in nano form.

2.4. Wild Harvested Products and Common/Public Land Management

General Principle

Organic management sustains and prevents degradation of common biotic and abiotic resources, including areas used for rangeland, fisheries, forests, and forage for bees, as well as neighbouring land, air and water.

Requirements:

2.4.1. Wild harvested products shall only be derived from a sustainable growing environment. Products shall not be harvested at a rate that exceeds the sustainable yield of the ecosystem, or threatens the existence of plant, fungal or animal species, including those not directly exploited.

2.4.2. Operators shall harvest products only from a clearly defined area where prohibited substances have not been applied.

2.4.3. The collection or harvest area shall be at an appropriate distance from conventional farming or other pollution sources in order to avoid contamination.

2.4.4. The operator who manages the harvesting or gathering of common resource products shall be familiar with the defined collecting or harvesting area, including the impacts of collectors not involved in the organic scheme.

2.4.5. Operators shall take measures to ensure that wild, sedentary aquatic species are collected only from areas where the water is not contaminated by substances prohibited in these standards.

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SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

3. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS FOR CROP PRODUCTION AND ANIMAL HUSBANDRY

3.1. Split Production and Parallel Production

General Principle

The whole farm, including livestock, is converted to organic management practices according to the standards over a period of time.

Requirements:

3.1.1. If the whole farm is not converted (split production) the organic and conventional parts of the farm shall be clearly and continuously separated.

3.1.2. Simultaneous production of the same products (parallel production) is only permitted where such production is undertaken in a way that allows clear and continuous and verifiable separation of all operations and products claimed as organic.

3.1.3. Organic and non-organic units in parallel production must be physically, financially and operationally separated.

3.1.4. Prohibited materials shall not be stored where organic products are grown and handled.

3.2. Maintenance of Organic Management

General Principle

Organic production systems require an ongoing commitment to organic production practices.

Recommendations:

In case of split or parallel production, the operator should demonstrate continuous efforts towards bringing the entire farm under organic management, such as increasing the size of the organic operation relative to the conventional or adopting organic practices in the conventional operation.

Requirements:

3.2.1. The production system shall not rely upon continuous switching between organic and conventional management.

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SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

4. CROP PRODUCTION

4.1. Choice of Crops and Varieties and propagation of planting materials

General Principle

Species and varieties cultivated in organic agriculture systems are selected for adaptability to the local soil and climatic conditions and tolerance to pests and diseases. All seeds and plant material are organic.

Recommendation:

Operators should give preference to organically bred varieties (varieties from organic breeding programs, see 4.7) when available.

Requirements:

4.1.1. Operators shall use organically produced seed and planting material whenever available in appropriate varieties and quality. When organic seed and planting materials are not available in sufficient quantity or quality for the required variety or equivalent varieties, in-conversion materials may be used. When none of these are available, conventional materials may be used provided that they have not been treated with post-harvest pesticides not otherwise permitted by this Standard.

Regional or other exception
Where post-harvest chemical treatment is prescribed by law for phytosanitary purposes, treated seed and plant material may be used.

4.1.2. Seeds and plant materials shall be propagated under organic management for one generation, in the case of annuals, and for perennials, two growing periods, or 18 months, whichever is the longer, before being certified as organic seed and plant material.

4.1.3. Propagation may be based on generative propagation (seeds) as well as vegetative propagation derived from various plant organs e.g.:

a Partitioned tubers, scales, husks;

b Partitioned bulbs, brood, bulbs, bulbils, offset bulbs etc.;

c Layer, cut and graft shoots;

d Rhizomes;

e Meristem culture.

4.1.4. All multiplication practices on the farm, except meristem culture, shall be under organic management.

4.1.5. Vegetal propagation materials, bedding materials and substrates shall only consist of substances listed in Appendices 2 and 3.

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4.2. Conversion Period (Plant Production)

General Principle

A conversion period enables the establishment of an organic management system and builds soil health and fertility.

Requirements:

4.2.1. All the requirements of this Standard shall be met for the duration of the conversion period.

4.2.2. The start of the conversion period shall be calculated from the date that an application has been received and agreed to by the control body.

Regional or other exception
The conversion period may be calculated retroactive to the application only on the basis of sound and incontrovertible evidence of full application of the standard for a period at least as long as 4.2.3.

South African Specific Guidance and Suggested Practice	
An alternative to starting conversion from the date of receipt of application is:	
a	Depending on the start of the agronomic season, the official date of either the closest spring or autumn.
b	This may be retroactive to the spring or autumn of the season in which the application was received and the first inspection conducted, provided that there is verified documentary proof that no prohibited practices or inputs have been used since that date.
c	The date may well be the spring or autumn following the first inspection.
d	The date is set by mutual agreement between the control body and the producer.
e	The administrative aim of this is to avoid the conversion anniversary occurring during the harvest season.

4.2.3. The length of the conversion period which reflects **active organic management** according to the requirements of this Standard shall be at least:

a 12 months before sowing or planting in the case of annual production;

b 12 months before grazing or harvest for pastures and meadows;

c 18 months before harvest for other perennials;

d 36 months for land where inputs not permitted with organic principles and the requirements of these standards have been used.

The periods required in a, b and c above run concurrently within the last corresponding period of the 36 months.

South African Specific
Exceptions may be granted in cases where a farmer can prove organic practices equivalent to those specified in 4.2.3 a, b and c above, prior to application for certification.

4.2.4. Plant products may be used or sold as “in-conversion” provided that they have completed a minimum 12-month conversion period.

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4.3. Diversity in Crop Production

General Principle

The development of living soils is the foundation of organic production. Soil health and quality are the basis of soil management practices and are critical to successful pest, disease and weed management. Organic growing systems are soil based, care for the soil and surrounding ecosystems, provide support for a diversity of species, are based on nutrient recycling and mitigate soil and nutrient losses.

Requirements:

4.3.1. Crop rotations for annual crops shall be established to manage pressure from pests, weeds and diseases and to maintain soil fertility, unless the operator ensures diversity in plant production by other means. Crop rotations shall be diverse and include soil-improving plants such as green manure, legumes or deep rooting plants.

4.3.2. For orchards and plantations, there shall be managed floor cover and diversity or refuge plantings.

4.4. Soil Fertility and Fertilization

General Principle

Organic farming returns microbial, plant or animal material to the soil to increase or at least maintain its fertility and biological activity.

Recommendation:

The fertility program should be based on material of microbial, plant or animal origin, such as green manure, compost or mulch, obtained through the following sources in this order of priority:

a Organically produced on the farm;

b Of organic quality, obtained from the surrounding farms or natural environment;

c Other inputs allowed under Appendix 2.

Nutrients and fertility products should be applied in a way that does not harm soil, water, and biodiversity (requirement 4.4.3). This should be evaluated through the use of appropriate indicators, such as:

a No significant accumulation of heavy metals or phosphorus in the soil;

b No significant contribution to the eutrophication of water bodies;

c Balanced nutrient supply as compared to the nutrient needs.;

d Maintenance or increase in soil carbon content over time.

Requirements:

4.4.1. Soil organic matter, microbial activity and general soil health and fertility shall be improved if low and maintained or improved if satisfactory. The operator shall prevent over-accumulation of heavy metals and other pollutants in the soils.

4.4.2. Material of microbial, plant or animal origin shall form the basis of the fertility program. Maintenance of fertility may not rely solely on off-farm inputs.

4.4.3. Nutrients and fertility products shall be applied in a way that does not harm soil, water, and biodiversity.

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4.4.4. Material applied to the land or crop shall be in accordance with Appendix 2.

4.4.5. Fertility amendments in Appendix 2 that are rapidly available to the plants are exceptionally allowed only as a necessary complement when other fertility building techniques have been applied and are insufficient.

South African Specific
4.4.6. Human excrement shall be handled in a way that eliminates the risk of pathogens and parasites. The use of human excrement should lead from human to plant, plant to animal, from composted animal manure to plant and then from plant back to man. The period of this cycle should be at least six months.

4.4.7. Minerals shall only be used in a program addressing long-term fertility needs together with other techniques such as organic matter additions, green manures, crop rotations and nitrogen fixation by plants. Their use shall be justified by appropriate soil and leaf analysis or diagnosed by an independent expert.

4.4.8. Minerals shall be applied in the form in which they are naturally composed and extracted and shall not be rendered more soluble by chemical treatment.

4.4.9. Chilean nitrate and all synthetic fertilizers, including urea, are prohibited.

4.4.10. The production of terrestrial plants shall be soil-based. The production of such crops in hydroponic systems is prohibited. "Soil-based" means that apart from the propagation or seedling stages, a plant must spend its life in the soil. For herbs, flowers and ornamentals in pots that are sold directly to the final consumer, the CB can allow production on permitted growing media.

4.4.11. The removal of soil from the farm is prohibited. Incidental removal of soil when harvesting crops is permitted.

4.5. Pest, Disease and Weed Management

General Principles

Organic farming systems apply biological and cultural means to prevent unacceptable losses from pests, diseases and weeds. They use crops and varieties that are well- adapted to the environment and a balanced fertility program to maintain fertile soils with high biological activity, locally adapted rotations, companion planting, green manures, functional biodiversity, habitat management, beneficial organisms and other recognized organic practices as described in this Standard.

Recommendation:

In case operators need to use commercial formulated inputs, preference should be given to formulations approved for use in organic agriculture by a specialized organic material review organization/program.

Requirements:

4.5.1. The organic production system shall include biological, cultural and mechanical mechanisms to manage pests, weeds and diseases. These include:

a Choice of appropriate species and varieties;

b Appropriate rotation programs, intercropping and companion planting;

c Mechanical cultivation;

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d Protection of natural enemies of pests through provision of favourable habitat, such as hedges, nesting sites and ecological buffer zones that maintain the original vegetation to house pest predators;

e Natural enemies including release of predators and parasites;

f Mulching and mowing;

g Grazing by animals;

h Mechanical controls such as traps, barriers, light and sound;

I On-farm preparations from local plants, animals and micro-organisms.

4.5.2. When the measures in 4.5.1 are not sufficient, pest, disease and weed management substances permitted under Appendix 3 may be used.

4.5.3. Substances that do not appear on Appendix 3 are prohibited for use in organic production.

4.5.4. Physical methods for pest, disease and weed management are permitted, including the application of heat.

4.5.5. Thermal sterilization of soils is prohibited.

Regional or other exception
Exceptions may be granted to protected cropping structures in instances of severe disease or pest infestation that cannot be otherwise remedied through measures in 4.5.1, 4.5.2 and 4.5.4.

4.5.6. Any formulated input shall have only active ingredients listed in Appendix 3.

All other ingredients shall not be carcinogens, teratogens, mutagens, or neurotoxins.

4.6. Avoiding Contamination

General Principle

All relevant measures are taken to ensure that organic soil and organic products are protected from contamination.

Requirements:

4.6.1. The operator shall monitor crops, soil, water, and inputs for risks of contamination by prohibited substances and environmental contaminants.

4.6.2. The operator shall employ measures including barriers and buffer zones to avoid potential contamination and limit contaminants in organic products.

South African specific	
(Ref Canada Organic Regime, CAN/CGSB-32.310)	
Buffer Zones	
If unintended contact with prohibited substances is possible, distinct buffer zones or other features sufficient to prevent contamination are required:	
a	Buffer zones shall be at least 8 m wide;
b	Permanent hedgerows or windbreaks, artificial windbreaks, permanent roads, or other physical barriers may be used instead of buffer zones;

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c	Crops grown in buffer zones shall not be considered organic whether or not they are used on the operation;
d	Crops at risk of contamination from commercialized GE crops shall be protected from cross-pollination. Mitigation strategies such as, but not limited to, physical barriers, border rows, strategic testing or delayed planting shall be implemented unless generally accepted isolation distances for the at-risk crop type are present (see Note below).
NOTE Generally accepted isolation distances for crops at risk of contamination from commercialized GE crop types include: soybeans – 10 m; corn – 300 m; canola, alfalfa (for seed production) and apples – 3 km.	

South African specific	
(Ref Canada Organic Regime, CAN/CGSB-32.310)	
Treated Wood	
Untreated wood or wood treated with substances listed in Appendix 3 {compare to: Table 4.2 (Column 2) of CAN/CGSB-32.311} are permitted, such as for fence posts.	
a	For new installations or replacement purposes, fence posts or wood treated with prohibited substances are prohibited. Alternatives, such as metal, plastic, concrete or protective sleeves, may be used.
b	Recycling of existing fence posts treated with prohibited substances within the operation is permitted.

4.6.3. All equipment from conventional farming systems shall be thoroughly cleaned of potentially contaminating materials before being used on organically managed areas.

4.6.4. For synthetic structure coverings, mulches, fleeces, insect netting and silage wrapping, only products based on polyethylene and polypropylene or other polycarbonates, and biodegradable materials (e.g., starch based), are permitted. These shall be removed from the soil after use and shall not be burned on the farmland.

4.7 Protected cropping

General principle

All the rules on crop production apply to protected cropping, including those concerning conversion period (4.2), diversity of crop production (4.3), and soil fertility and fertilization (4.4). Natural light, air and water are essential components of organic plant production.

Recommendations:

Energy used for light and climate control should be from renewable resources. Technologies that reduce energy consumption should be used.

Requirements:

4.7.1. Artificial light is only allowed for plant propagation and as a complement to sunlight to extend the day length to a maximum of 16 hours.

4.7.2. Operators shall monitor, record and optimize any energy used for artificial light, heating, cooling, ventilation, humidity and other climate control.

4.8. Breeding of organic varieties

Explanatory Note: This section refers to breeding of organic varieties, not simply use or production of organic seeds from regular (conventional) varieties.

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General Principles

Organic plant breeding and variety development is sustainable, enhances genetic diversity and relies on natural reproductive ability. It aims for new varieties particularly suited for organic production systems. Organic breeding is always creative, cooperative and open for science, intuition, and new findings. Organic plant breeding is a holistic approach that respects natural crossing barriers. Organic plant breeding is based on fertile plants that can establish a viable relationship with the living soil. Organic varieties are obtained by an organic plant breeding program.

Requirements:

4.8.1. To produce organic varieties, plant breeders shall select their varieties under organic conditions that comply with the requirements of this Standard. All multiplication practices except meristem culture shall be under certified organic management.

4.8.2. Organic plant breeders shall develop organic varieties only on the basis of genetic material that has not been contaminated by products of genetic engineering.

4.8.3. Organic plant breeders shall disclose the applied breeding techniques. Organic plant breeders shall make the information about the methods, which were used to develop an organic variety, available for the public latest from the beginning of marketing of the seeds.

4.8.4. The genome is respected as an impartible entity. Technical interventions into the genome of plants are not allowed (e.g., ionizing radiation; transfer of isolated DNA, RNA, or proteins).

4.8.5. The cell is respected as an impartible entity. Technical interventions into an isolated cell on an artificial medium are not allowed (e.g., genetic engineering techniques; destruction of cell walls and disintegration of cell nuclei through cytoplast fusion).

4.8.6. The natural reproductive ability of a plant variety is respected and maintained.

This excludes techniques that reduce or inhibit the germination capacities (e.g., terminator technologies).

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This Section combines the conversion periods and breeding sections of the IFOAM Norms (which the Standards Committee felt were inadequate) with the EU 2018-848 in order to derive guidance for those certifiers using this standard.

SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

5. ANIMAL HUSBANDRY

5.1. Animal Management

General Principle

Organic livestock husbandry is based on the harmonious relationship between land, plants and livestock, respect for the physiological and behavioural needs of livestock and the feeding of good-quality organically grown feedstuffs. Stocking rates for livestock should be appropriate for the region in question taking into consideration the body size/weight of the breeds maintained, feed production capacity, stock health, nutrient balance, and environmental impact.

SOUTH AFRICA specific
Management of the animal environment shall be by personnel who possess the necessary basic knowledge and skills regarding the health and welfare needs of the animals.

Recommendations:

Ecologically acceptable and ethical management strategies to deal with wild animal and livestock farming conflicts should be encouraged.

Requirements:

5.1.1. Landless animal husbandry systems are prohibited.

5.1.2. The operator shall ensure that the environment, the facilities, stocking density and flock/herd size provides for the behavioural needs of the animals.

5.1.3. In particular, the operator shall ensure the following animal welfare conditions:

a Sufficient free movement and opportunity to express normal patterns of behaviour;

b Space to stand naturally, lie down easily, move around freely, groom themselves, sleep and nest comfortably, as well as assume all natural postures and movements such as stretching etc.;

c Sufficient fresh air, water, feed, thermal comfort and natural daylight, to satisfy the needs of the animals;

d Access to resting areas, shelter and protection from sunlight, temperature, rain, mud and wind adequate to reduce animal stress;

e Provision of suitable materials and areas for exploratory and foraging behaviours;

f In addition to these general welfare conditions for all animal categories, provisions for specific animal groups also have to be taken into account, e.g., for cattle: social grooming and grazing; for

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pigs: rooting, separate lying, activity/dunging- and feeding-areas, free farrowing, group housing; for poultry: nesting, wing stretching/flapping, foraging, dust-bathing, perching and preening.

Regional or other exception
On holdings where, due to their geographical location and structural constraints, it is not possible to allow free movement of animals, indoor tethering and / or stanchioning of animals may be allowed for a limited period of the year or of the day. In such cases, animals may not be able to turn around freely but the tethering conditions must fulfil all other requirements.

SOUTH AFRICAN specific	
Note: animals whose management system requires outdoor tethering to make use of grazing can still be managed in compliance with these requirements. Tethering must however be managed in compliance with all points under para. 5.1 with due notice taken of the following:	
a	Animals to be tethered on grass where they can graze, with adequate access to shade and water;
b	The animal must have sufficient free movement to express normal behaviour, and have enough space to stand naturally, lie down easily, move around and groom themselves;
c	Animals are to have protection from sunlight and sufficient water.
d	Animals to be regularly visited and monitored;
e	The tethering must not produce injuries.

5.1.4. Herd animals shall not be kept in isolation from other animals of the same species. This provision does not apply to small herds for mostly self-sufficient production. Operators may isolate male animals, sick animals and those about to give birth.

5.1.5. Construction materials and methods and production equipment that might significantly harm human or animal health shall not be used.

5.1.6. Operators shall manage pests and diseases in livestock housing and shall use the following methods according to these priorities:

a Preventative methods such as disruption, elimination of habitat and access to facilities;

b Mechanical, physical and biological methods.

c Substances (other than synthetic pesticides) used in traps.

d Substances listed in Appendix 5 of this Standard;

Regional or other exception
Other products may be used if required by law for the control of notifiable diseases.

5.1.7. When animals are housed, the operator shall ensure that:

a Where animals require bedding, adequate natural materials are provided. Bedding materials that are normally consumed by the animals shall be organic.

b Building construction provides for insulation, heating, cooling and ventilation of the building, ensuring that air circulation, dust levels, temperature, relative air humidity, and gas concentrations are within levels that are not harmful to the livestock.

c No animals shall be kept in closed cages.

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d	Animals are protected from predation by wild and feral animals.
e	The above animal welfare requirements are fulfilled.
f	Animals are regularly visited and monitored.
g	When welfare and health problems occur, appropriate management adjustments are implemented (e.g., reducing stocking density).

	SOUTH AFRICAN specific
h	The minimum surface areas for perches, indoor housing and outdoor exercise areas are laid out in Appendix 6.
i	At least half the floor area of livestock housing must be solid, not of slatted or of grid construction and the floors must not be slippery: Provided that the area may be reduced to one third for poultry.
j	Calves may not be housed in individual boxes after the age of one week.
k	Sows must be kept in groups except in the last stages of pregnancy and during the suckling period and piglets may not be kept on flat decks or in piglet cages.
l	The exercise areas for pigs must permit dunging and rooting by the animals.
m	Water fowl must have access to a stream, pond or lake.
n	Poultry houses/buildings must have exit/entry pop-holes of adequate size (defined in Section B Appendix 6b) for the birds and the pop-holes must have a combined length of at least 4 m per 100 m² of the house/building.
o	Each poultry house/building may not contain more than 4 800 chickens, 3 000 laying hens, 5 200 guinea fowl, 4 000 female Muscovy and Peking ducks, 3 200 male Muscovy or Peking ducks or other ducks, 2 500 capons, geese or turkeys and the total usable area of poultry houses/buildings for meat production on any single production unit must not exceed 1 600 m².
p	Poultry buildings must be emptied of livestock between each batch of poultry reared, cleaned and disinfected and the open-air runs must be left empty in order for the vegetation to grow back.
q	If there are both organically and non-organically managed livestock on the same farm (split production) they must be reared on units where the buildings and parcels are clearly separated, and a different species is involved.
r	Housing shall ensure that animals are protected from predation by wild and feral animals.

5.1.8. All animals shall have unrestricted and daily access to pasture or a soil-based open-air exercise area or run, with vegetation, whenever the physiological condition of the animal, the weather and the state of the ground permit. Such areas may be partially covered. Animals may temporarily be kept indoors because of inclement weather, health condition, reproduction, specific handling requirements or at night. Lactation shall not be considered a valid condition for keeping animals indoors.

5.1.9. The maximum hours of artificial light used to prolong natural day length shall not exceed a maximum that respects the natural behaviour, geographical conditions and general health of the animals. For laying hens, a minimum daily rest period of 8 continuous hours without artificial light shall be respected.

	South African specific
	(Ref Canada Organic Regime, CAN/CGSB-32.310)
5.1.10.	Additional requirements for rabbits
a	If required for comfort and security, rabbits may be temporarily confined, for example, overnight, in cages or hutches. Continuous confinement is prohibited.
b	The use of mobile pasture pens is permitted, provided that pens do not restrict natural behaviour and they are moved at least once every three days.

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c	Rabbits shall have space to run, hop and dig, and to sit upright on their back legs with ears erect.
d	Rabbits shall not be subjected to continuous lighting or kept in permanent darkness. During the day, rabbits shall be able to clearly see each other and their surroundings.
e	Does about to give birth shall be given secluded individual burrows or nest boxes for kindling (birthing).
f	The doe and litter shall have free access to outdoor range and foraging areas once the kits reach 21 days of age.
g	Weaning before the kits are 30 days of age is prohibited. However, if the welfare of the doe or kits is compromised, earlier weaning is permitted.

5.2. Animal Origin and Conversion Period

General Principle

Organic animals are born and raised on organic holdings. Animal husbandry systems that change from conventional to organic production require a conversion period.

Requirements:

5.2.1. If there is simultaneous conversion of the complete production unit, including livestock, pasturage and / or any land used for livestock feed, animals and animal products may be considered organic at the end of the conversion period of the land and crops, even if the conversion period for the type of animals concerned is longer, given that:

a This applies only to the unit's existing animals and their offspring and at the same time also to the land used for animal feed / pasturage before starting the conversion;

b Animals present on the unit since the beginning of the conversion period may be fed with in-conversion feed produced on the in-conversion unit or with organic feed.

South African Guidance	
5.2.2	Conversion periods specific to the type of animal production are set out as follows:
a	12 months in the case of bovine animals and equine animals for meat production, and in any case no less than three quarters of their lifetime;
b	6 months in the case of ovine animals, caprine animals and porcine animals and animals for milk production;
c	10 weeks for poultry for meat production, except for Peking ducks, brought in before they are three days old;
d	7 weeks for Peking ducks brought in before they are three days old;
e	6 weeks in the case of poultry for egg production brought in before they are three days old;
f	3 months for rabbits.

South African specific poultry derogation for the domestic market only.
In cases where it is not feasible to bring in three-day-old chickens, then pullets of 16 weeks of age may be brought in and undergo a 6-week conversion period. This is specifically to facilitate the development of the commercial South African organic poultry sector.
The derogation is for a period of five (5) years after the publication date of this Standard.

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5.2.3 Offspring may be considered organic only if their mother has been organically managed throughout the pregnancy.

Milk may be considered organic only if the dairy animal has been organically managed throughout the pregnancy preceding lactation.

Eggs may be considered organic only if the poultry has been organically managed from 3 days old.

South African specific poultry derogation for the domestic market only.
In cases where it is not feasible to bring in 3-day old chickens, then pullets of 16 weeks of age may be brought in and undergo a 6-week conversion period. This is specifically to facilitate the development of the commercial South African organic poultry sector.
The derogation is for a period of five (5) years after the publication date of this Standard.

5.2.4 Animals for meat shall be raised organically from birth.

Regional or other exception
When organic poultry is not available 2-day old conventional poultry may be brought in.

5.2.5 Breeding stock:

a Breeding stock may be brought in from conventional farms to a yearly maximum of 10% of the adult animals of the same species on the farm. Non- organic female breeding replacements must be nulliparous.

b Common minimum conversion requirements: dairy – 90 days; eggs and poultry meat – 42 days; other meat – 12 months.

Regional or other exception	
Exceptions of more than 10% for breeding livestock may be granted, limited to the following circumstances:	
a	Unforeseen severe natural or man-made events;
b	Considerable enlargement of the farm;
c	Establishment of a new type of animal production enterprise on the farm;
d	Holdings with less than 10 animals.

South African specific poultry derogation for the domestic market only.
In cases where it is not feasible to bring in three-day-old chickens, then pullets of 16 weeks of age may be brought in and undergo a 6-week conversion period. This is specifically to facilitate the development of the commercial South African organic poultry sector.
The derogation is for a period of five (5) years after the publication date of this Standard.

5.3. Breeds and Breeding

General Principle

Breeds are adapted to local conditions.

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Requirements:

South African Guidance	
5.3.1 Without prejudice to the rules on conversion, organic livestock shall be born or hatched and raised on organic production units.	
5.3.1.1 For breeding purposes, non-organically raised animals may be brought to an organic production unit when breeds are in danger of being lost to farming. In such cases, the animals of those breeds need not necessarily be nulliparous.	
5.3.1.2 Where a flock is constituted for the first time, or is renewed or reconstituted, and where the qualitative and quantitative needs of farmers cannot be met, the Certification Body may decide that non-organically reared poultry may be brought into an organic poultry production unit, provided that the pullets for the production of eggs and poultry for meat production are less than three days old. Products derived from them may only be considered as organic if the conversion period has been complied with.	
5.3.1.3 Certifiers may authorise the introduction of non-organic animals into an organic production unit where organic animals are not available in sufficient quality or quantity where the producer is located.	
5.3.1.4 For breeding purposes, non-organic young animals may be introduced when a herd or flock is constituted for the first time. They shall be reared in accordance with the organic production rules immediately after they are weaned. In addition, the following restrictions shall apply on the date on which those animals enter the herd or flock:	
a	Bovine animals, equine animals and cervine animals shall be less than six months old;
b	Ovine animals and caprine animals shall be less than 60 days old;
c	Porcine animals shall weigh less than 35 kg;
d	Rabbits shall be less than three months old.
5.3.1.5 For breeding purposes, non-organic adult male and non-organic nulliparous female animals may be introduced for the renewal of a herd or flock. They shall be reared subsequently in accordance with the organic production rules. In addition, the number of female animals shall be subject to the following restrictions per year:	
a	Up to a maximum of 10 % of adult equine animals or bovine animals and 20 % of the adult porcine animals, ovine animals, caprine animals, rabbits or cervine animals may be introduced;
b	For units with fewer than 10 equine animals, cervine animals or bovine animals or rabbits, or with fewer than five porcine animals, ovine animals or caprine animals, any such renewal shall be limited to a maximum of one animal per year.
5.3.1.6 The percentages set in point 5.3.4.5 may be increased up to 40 %, provided that the competent authority has confirmed that any of following conditions is fulfilled:	
a	A major extension to the farm has been undertaken;
b	One breed has been replaced with another;
c	A new livestock specialisation has been initiated.
5.3.1.7 Non-organic animals may only be considered as organic if the specified conversion periods have been complied with. The conversion period shall start, at the earliest, once the animals are introduced into the in-conversion production unit.	
5.3.1.8 Non-organic animals shall either be kept separate from other livestock or shall be kept identifiable until the end of the conversion period.	

South African specific poultry derogation for the domestic market only.
In cases where it is not feasible to bring in 3-day old chickens, then pullets of 16 weeks of age may be brought in and undergo a 6-week conversion period. This is specifically to facilitate the development of the commercial South African organic poultry sector.
The derogation is for a period of five (5) years after the publication date of this Standard.

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5.3.2. Breeding systems shall be based on breeds that can reproduce successfully under natural conditions without human involvement.

5.3.3. Artificial insemination is permitted.

5.3.4. Embryo transfer techniques and cloning are prohibited.

5.3.5. Hormones are prohibited to induce ovulation and birth unless applied to individual animals for medical reasons and under veterinary supervision.

South African Guidance
5.3.6. Practices shall ensure a high standard of animal welfare and shall contribute to the prevention of any suffering of animals. The choice of breeds shall be appropriate to the principles of organic production.
5.3.7. When choosing breeds or strains, operators shall consider giving preference to those with a high degree of genetic diversity, the capacity of animals to adapt to local conditions, their breeding value, their longevity, their vitality and their resistance to disease or health problems, all without impairment of their welfare. In addition, breeds or strains of animals shall be selected to avoid specific diseases or health problems associated with some breeds or strains used in intensive production, such as porcine stress syndrome, possibly leading to pale-soft-exudative (PSE) meat, sudden death, spontaneous abortion and difficult births requiring caesarean operations. Preference shall be given to indigenous breeds and strains.

5.4. Mutilations

General Principle

Organic farming respects the animal's distinctive characteristics.

Requirements:

5.4.1. Mutilations are prohibited.

Regional or other exception	
The following exceptions may be used only if animal suffering is minimized and anaesthetics are used where appropriate:	
a	Castrations;
b	Tail docking of lambs;
c	Dehorning;
d	Ringing, except for pigs;

5.5. Animal Nutrition

General Principle

Organic animals receive their nutritional needs from organic forage and feed of good quality.

Requirements:

5.5.1. Animals shall be fed organic feed.

Regional or other exception
Operators may feed a limited percentage of non-organic feed under specific conditions in a, b and c below.

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The percentage of non-organic feed may not exceed 10% dry matter per ruminant and 15% dry matter per non-ruminant calculated on an annual basis.	
Operators may feed a higher percentage of non-organic feed for a limited time under specific conditions, following extreme and exceptional weather conditions or manmade or natural disasters beyond the control of the operator.	
Exceptions (to a maximum of double the 10% and 15% mentioned above) may be permitted in regions where organic feed production is in an early stage of development or temporarily deficient, or in cases of unpredictably low crop production on the farm or in the region.	
a	Organic feed is of inadequate quantity or quality;
b	Areas where organic agriculture is in early stages of development;
c	Grazing of non-organic grass or vegetation during seasonal migration;
d	Short-term (less than one rain season) drought.

5.5.2. Animals shall be offered a balanced diet that provides all of the nutritional needs of the animals in a form allowing them to exhibit their natural feeding and digestive behaviour.

5.5.3. For ruminants, 80%, and for all other livestock, 50% of the feed must come from the farm unit itself, surrounding natural grazing areas which have not been subjected to prohibited or restricted inputs, or be produced in co-operation with other organic farms in the region.

Regional or other exception
Notifiable exceptions, arising from natural disasters, may be permitted.

5.5.4. For the calculation of feeding allowances only, feed produced on the farm unit during the first year of organic management may be classed as organic. This refers only to feed for animals that are being produced within the farm unit. Such feed may not be sold or otherwise marketed as organic.

5.5.5. The following substances are prohibited in the diet:

a Farm animal by-products (e.g., abattoir waste) to ruminants;

b Slaughter products of the same species;

c Intentional feeding of all types of excrements including droppings, dung or other manure;

d Feed subjected to solvent extraction (e.g., hexane) or the addition of other chemical agents;

e Synthetic amino-acids and amino-acid isolates;

f Urea and other synthetic nitrogen compounds;

g Synthetic growth promoters or stimulants;

h Synthetic appetizers;

i Preservatives, except when used as a processing aid;

j Artificial colouring agents.

5.5.6. Animals may be fed vitamins, trace elements and supplements from natural sources.

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Regional or other exception
Synthetic vitamins, minerals and supplements may be used when natural sources are not available in sufficient quantity and quality.

5.5.7. All ruminants shall have daily access to roughage. Ruminants must be grazed throughout the entire grazing season(s).

Regional or other exception
Ruminants may be fed with purchased organic fresh fodder during the grazing season where weather and soil conditions do not permit grazing. The purchased organic fresh fodder shall not exceed 20% of the amount of forage fed during the grazing season. Animal welfare shall not be compromised.
The certification body may allow the feeding of animals with carried fresh fodder, silage and hay if this is a more sustainable way to use land resources than grazing. Animal welfare shall not be compromised.

5.5.8. Fodder preservatives such as the following may be used:

a Bacteria, fungi and enzymes;

b Natural products of food industry;

c Plant based products.

d Vitamins and minerals subject to 5.5.6.

Regional or other exception
Synthetic chemical fodder preservatives such as acetic, formic and propionic acid are permitted in severe weather conditions.

5.5.9. Young stock from mammals shall be provided maternal milk or organic milk from their own species and shall be weaned only after a minimum period as specified below:

a Calves and foals: 3 months

b Piglets: 6 weeks

c Lambs and kids: 7 weeks

5.6. Veterinary Medicine

General Principle

Organic management practices promote and maintain the health and well-being of animals through balanced organic nutrition, stress-free living conditions and breed selection for resistance to diseases, parasites and infections.

Requirements:

5.6.1.

The operator shall take all practical measures to ensure the health and well-being of the animals through preventative animal husbandry practices such as:

a Selection of appropriate breeds or strains of animals;

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b Adoption of animal husbandry practices appropriate to the requirements of each species, such as regular exercise and access to pasture and / or open-air runs, to encourage the natural immunological defence of animal to stimulate natural immunity and tolerance to diseases;

c Provision of good quality organic feed;

d Appropriate stocking densities;

e Grazing rotation and management.

5.6.2. If an animal becomes sick or injured despite preventative measures, that animal shall be treated promptly and adequately, if necessary, in isolation and in suitable housing. Operators shall give preference to natural medicines and treatments, including homeopathy, Ayurvedic medicine and acupuncture.

5.6.3. Use of synthetic allopathic veterinary drugs or antibiotics will cause the animal to lose its organic status. Producers shall not withhold such medication where doing so will result in unnecessary suffering of the livestock.

Regional or other exception	
Exceptions may be permitted allowing the animal to retain its organic status if:	
a	The operator can demonstrate compliance with 5.6.1, and
b	Natural and alternative medicines and treatments are unlikely to be effective to cure sickness or injury, or are not available to the operator, and
c	The chemically synthetized allopathic veterinary medical products or antibiotics are used under the supervision of a veterinarian, and
d	Withdrawal periods shall be not less than double of that required by legislation, or a minimum of 14 days, whichever is longer.
e	This exception is granted for a maximum of three courses of remedial treatments with chemically synthesized allopathic veterinary medicinal products or antibiotics within 12 months, or one course of treatment if the productive lifecycle of the animal is less than one year.

South African specific
5.6.4. Producers shall not withhold such medication where doing so will result in unnecessary suffering of the livestock. When allopathic veterinary products are used, the withdrawal period shall be at least double the legal period, or at least 48 hours when no withdrawal period is specified.

5.6.5. Prophylactic use of any synthetic allopathic veterinary drug is prohibited.

5.6.6. Substances of synthetic origin used to stimulate production or suppress natural growth are prohibited.

5.6.7. Vaccinations are allowed only in the following cases:

a When an endemic disease is known or expected to be a problem in the region of the farm and where this disease cannot be controlled by other management techniques, or

b When a vaccination is legally required.

5.7. Transport and Slaughter

General Principle

Organic animals are subjected to minimum stress during transport and slaughter.

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Requirements:

5.7.1. Animals shall be handled calmly and gently during transport and slaughter.

5.7.2. The regular use of electric prods and other such instruments is prohibited, with the exception of ensuring the physical safety of livestock and humans. In such cases the use thereof must be recorded together with plans to prevent the reoccurrence in the future.

5.7.3. Organic animals shall be provided with conditions during transportation and slaughter that reduce and minimize the adverse effects of: stress, loading and unloading, mixing different groups of animals, extreme temperatures and relative humidity. The type of transport shall meet the specific needs of the species being transported.

5.7.4. The operator shall ensure an adequate food and water supply during transport and at the slaughterhouse.

5.7.5. Animals shall not be treated with synthetic tranquilizers or stimulants prior to or during transport.

5.7.6. Each animal or group of animals shall be identifiable at each step in the transport and slaughter process.

5.7.7. Slaughterhouse journey times shall not exceed eight hours.

Regional or other exception
When there is no certified organic slaughterhouse within eight hours travel time, animals may be transported for a longer period if they are given a rest period and access to water and, if necessary, to feed.

5.7.8. Those responsible for transportation and slaughtering shall avoid contact (sight, sound or smell) of each live animal with dead animals or animals in the killing process.

5.7.9. Each animal shall be effectively stunned before being bled to death. The equipment used for stunning shall be in good working order.

Regional or other exception
Exceptions can be made according to religious practice. Where animals are bled without prior stunning this should take place in a calm environment. Slaughter techniques must prioritize animal welfare and aim to eliminate any stress, pain, or suffering endured by the animal.

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SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

6. Wild harvesting of plants

6.1. Organic wild collection may be done of plants or parts thereof that grow naturally in areas that are not maintained under cultivation or other agricultural management systems, if they are harvested under the following conditions:

a If they are derived from a stable and sustainable growing environment, provided that harvesting or gathering does not exceed the sustainable yield of the ecosystem, or does not affect the stability of the natural habitat, or the maintenance of the species in the collecting area;

b If the collecting area is clearly defined and mapped, and if the plants or parts thereof can legally be harvested by the producer and it can be proved not to overlap with collection by other persons, and if it is not exposed to prohibited substances;

c If the collecting area is separated from conventional farming, pollution and contamination by a buffer zone which satisfies the requirements of Section 4.6.2;

d If collectors are supervised by the producer and trained to respect the border of the collection area and to identify which species to collect, with due consideration to the long-term sustainability of the collected species and all other natural species in the area. This aspect shall include methods of collection, intensity of harvesting, seasonality, and correct vegetative state for collection.;

e If the area has not received treatments with substances that are not in accordance with this Standard for a period of at least three years before collection;

f If the producer has a manual which identifies the risks to the environment and the measures that were taken to reduce those risks; and

g If all post-harvest procedures, including transportation and storage, meet the general requirements in Section 4 for the production of organic products.

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SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

7. Bee Keeping

7.1 Bee management

General Principle

Bee keeping is an important activity that contributes to enhancement of the agriculture and forestry production through the pollinating action of bees.

Requirements:

7.1.1. The areas within a 3 km radius of the hives shall consist of organically managed fields, uncultivated land and / or wild natural areas in a way that ensures access to sources of honeydew, nectar and pollen that meets organic crop production requirements sufficient to supply all of the bees' nutritional needs.

7.1.2. The operator shall not place hives within a foraging distance (5 kms) of fields or other areas with a high contamination risk (e.g., conventional fields, industrial zones and highways).

7.1.3. The hives shall consist primarily of natural materials and present no risk of contamination to the environment or the bee products. Use of construction materials with potentially toxic effects is prohibited.

7.1.4. At the end of the production season, hives shall be left with reserves of honey and pollen sufficient for the colony to survive the dormancy period. Any supplementary feeding in response to unexpected need shall be carried out only between the last honey harvest and the start of the next nectar or honeydew flow period. In such cases, organic honey or organic sugar shall be used.

7.2. Bee Origin and Conversion Period

General Principle

Organic bees are born and raised on organic holdings. Bee husbandry systems that change from conventional to organic production require a conversion period.

Requirements:

Conversion Periods

7.2.1. Conversion period for bees shall be 12 months.

7.2.2. During the conversion period, the wax shall be replaced by organically produced wax. However, non-organic beeswax may be used:

a Where beeswax from organic beekeeping is not available on the market;

b Where it is proven free of contamination with products or substances not authorised for use in organic production;

c Provided that it comes from the cap;

d In cases where all the wax cannot be replaced during a one-year period, the conversion period shall be extended to cover the full replacement of the wax.

7.3. Breeding

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7.3.1. For the renovation of apiaries, 20 % per year of the queen bees and swarms may be replaced by non-organic queen bees and swarms in the organic production unit, provided that the queen bees and swarms are placed in hives with combs or comb foundations coming from organic production units. In any case, one swarm or queen bee may be replaced per year by a non-organic swarm or a queen bee.

7.3.2. Artificial insemination of queen bees is permitted.

7.4. Veterinary Practices

General Principle

Organic management practices promote and maintain the health and well-being of bees.

Requirements:

7.4.1. For pest and disease control the following are permitted:

a Lactic acid, formic acid;

b Oxalic acid, acetic acid;

c Sulphur;

d Natural essential oils (e.g., menthol, eucalyptol, camphor);

e *Bacillus thuringiensis*;

f Steam, direct flame and caustic soda for hive disinfection.

g Cultures of beneficial micro-organisms.

7.4.2. Where preventative measures fail, veterinary medicinal products may be used provided the following are adhered to:

a Preference is given to phytotherapeutic and homeopathic treatment;

b If allopathic chemically synthesized medicinal products are used, the bee products shall not be sold as organic;

c Treated hives shall be placed in isolation and undergo a conversion period of one year.

7.4.3. The practice of destroying the male brood is permitted only to contain infestation with *Varroa* (mites).

7.4.5. The health and welfare of the hive shall be primarily achieved by hygiene and hive management.

7.4.6. Mutilations, such as clipping of the wings of queen bees, are prohibited.

7.5. Harvesting of Honey

General Principle

The welfare of the bees shall be maintained during harvesting of honey.

Requirements

7.5.1. The destruction of bees in the combs as a method of harvesting of bee products is prohibited.

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7.5.2. The use of chemical synthetic bee repellents is prohibited. The use of smoke should be kept to a minimum. Acceptable smoking materials should be natural or from materials that meet the requirements of these standards.

7.5.3. Honey temperatures shall be maintained as low as possible, and not exceed 45°C, during the extraction and processing of products derived from bee keeping.

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SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

SOUTH AFRICAN specific

8. MUSHROOM PRODUCTION

8.1. For production of mushrooms, only the following substrates may be used:

a Farmyard manure, slurry and urine:

i. either from holdings producing according to the organic production method;
ii. or satisfying the requirements referred to in Appendix 2 for the listed products, and up to 25 % (by weight of total components of the substrate, excluding the covering material and added water before composting), and only when the product under 8.a.i. is not available.

b Products of agricultural origin, other than those covered under point 8.a (e.g., straw), from holdings producing according to organic production method.

c Peat not chemically treated.

d Wood, not treated with chemical products after felling.

e Mineral products listed in Annex II, water and soil.

8.2. Mushroom compost as substrate may only be sterilized by pasteurization.

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SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

9. AQUACULTURE PRODUCTION STANDARDS

9.1. Aquatic Ecosystems

General Principle

Organic aquaculture management maintains the biodiversity of natural aquatic ecosystems, the health of the aquatic environment, and the quality of the surrounding aquatic and terrestrial ecosystem.

Requirements:

9.1.1. Aquatic ecosystems shall be managed to comply with relevant requirements of Section 2.

9.1.2. Operators shall take adequate measures to prevent escapes of introduced or cultivated species and document any that are known to occur.

9.1.3. Operators shall take verifiable and effective measures to minimize the release of nutrients and waste into the aquatic ecosystem.

9.1.4. Fertilizers and pesticides are prohibited unless they appear in Appendices 2 and 3.

9.2. Conversion to Organic Aquaculture

General Principle

Organic aquaculture production reflects the diversity of species and production methods.

Requirements:

9.2.1. Operators shall comply with all the relevant general requirements of chapters 3 and 5.

9.2.2. The conversion period of the production unit shall be at least one life cycle of the organism or one year, whichever is shorter.

9.2.3. Operators shall ensure that conversion to organic aquaculture addresses environmental factors, and past use of the site with respect to waste, sediments and water quality and health.

9.2.4. Production units must be located at an appropriate minimum distance from contamination sources and conventional aquaculture.

9.3. Aquatic Plants

General Principle

Organic aquatic plants are grown and harvested sustainably without adverse impacts on natural areas.

Requirements:

9.3.1. Aquatic plant production shall comply with the relevant requirements of Sections 2, 3 and 4.

9.3.2. Harvest of aquatic plants shall not disrupt the ecosystem or degrade the collection area or the surrounding aquatic and terrestrial environment.

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9.4. Breeds and Breeding

General Principle

Organic aquatic animals begin life in organic units.

Requirements:

9.4.1. Aquatic animals shall be raised organically from birth.

Regional or other exception
When organic aquatic animals are not available, brought-in conventional animals shall spend not less than two thirds of their life span in the organic system.
When organic stock is not available, conventional sources may be used. To promote and establish the use of organic stock, the control body shall set time limits for the selected use of non-organic sources.

9.4.2. Operators shall not utilize artificially polyploided organisms or artificially produced mono-sex stock.

South African specific derogation for the domestic market only
Polyploided and mono-sex organisms may be used for a period of five (5) years after the publication date of this Standard to facilitate the development of the organic trout production sector.

9.4.3. Aquatic animal production systems shall use breeds and breeding techniques suited to the region and the production method.

9.5. Aquatic Animal Nutrition

General Principle

Organic aquatic animals receive their nutritional needs from good quality, organic sources.

Requirements:

9.5.1. Aquatic animals shall be fed organic feed.

Regional or other exception	
Operators may feed a limited percentage of non-organic feed under specific conditions for a limited time in the following cases:	
a	Organic feed is of inadequate quantity or quality
b	Areas where organic aquaculture is in early stages of development.

9.5.2. The dietary requirements for aquatic animals shall comply with the requirements of 5.5.

9.5.3. Use of water containing human excrement is prohibited.

9.6. Aquatic Animal Health and Welfare

General Principles

Organic management practices promote and maintain the health and well-being of animals through balanced organic nutrition, stress-free living conditions appropriate to the species and breed selection for resistance to diseases, parasites and infections.

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Requirements:

9.6.1. Operators shall comply with relevant requirements of section 5.6.

9.6.2. Prophylactic use of veterinary drugs is prohibited.

9.6.3. Operators must use natural methods and medicines, as the first choice, when treatment is necessary. Use of chemical allopathic veterinary drugs and antibiotics is prohibited for invertebrates.

9.6.4. Synthetic hormones and growth promoters are prohibited for use to artificially stimulate growth or reproduction.

9.6.5. Stocking densities do not compromise animal welfare.

9.6.6. Operators shall routinely monitor water quality, stocking densities, health, and behaviour of each cohort (school) and manage the operation to maintain water quality, health, and natural behaviour.

9.7. Aquatic Animal Transport and Slaughter

General Principle

Organic aquatic animals are subjected to minimum stress during transport and slaughter.

Requirements:

9.7.1. Operators shall comply with relevant requirements of section 5.7.

9.7.2. The operator shall handle live organisms in ways that are compatible with their physiological requirements.

9.7.3. Operators shall implement defined measures to ensure that organic aquatic animals are provided with conditions during transportation and slaughter that meet animal specific needs and minimize the adverse effects of:

a Diminishing water quality;

b Time spent in transport;

c Stocking density;

d Toxic substances;

e Escape.

9.7.4. Aquatic vertebrates shall be stunned before killing. Operators shall ensure that equipment used to stun animals is sufficient to remove sensate ability and / or kill the organism and is maintained and monitored.

9.7.5. Aquatic animals shall be handled, transported and slaughtered in a way that minimizes stress and suffering, and respects species-specific needs.

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SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

20. PROCESSING AND HANDLING

20.1. General

General Principle

Organic processing and handling provide consumers with supplies of certified organic products, and organic farmers with a market without compromise to the organic integrity of their products.

Requirements:

South African specific
Producers are required to have documented policies and procedures ensuring that these requirements are kept. HACCP type protocols, including Organic Control Points, which ensure organic integrity, should be implemented as a minimum. Compliance with all national legislation is required.

20.1.1. Handlers and processors shall not co-mingle organic products with non-organic products.

20.1.2. Handlers and processers shall ensure traceability in the organic processing and handling chain.

20.1.3. All organic products shall be clearly identified / labelled as such and processed, stored and transported in a way that prevents co-mingling, contamination and or substitution by or physical contact with non-certified products.

20.1.4. When non-organic products are prepared or stored in the preparation unit, the operator shall inform the control body.

20.1.5. The handler or processor shall take all necessary measures to prevent organic products from being contaminated by pollutants and contaminants, including the cleaning, decontamination, or if necessary, disinfection of facilities and equipment.

20.1.6. The handler or processor shall identify and minimize risks of environmental pollution resulting from their activity.

20.1.7. Processors shall respect the principles of good manufacturing practices. This shall include maintaining appropriate procedures based on identification of critical processing steps.

20.2. Ingredients

General Principle

Organic processed products are made from organic ingredients.

Requirements:

20.2.1. Ingredients of agricultural origin used in an organic processed product shall be organically produced in accordance with the labelling requirements (Section 22 Labelling, clause 22.1.3.) except for those additives and processing aids that appear in Appendix 4.

Regional or other exception
In cases where an ingredient of organic origin is commercially unavailable in sufficient quality or quantity, operators may use non-organic raw materials, provided that:

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a	They are not genetically engineered or contain nano-materials;
b	The current lack of availability in that region is officially recognized or prior permission from the control body is obtained. Official recognition may be by inclusion on a government or certification body list of permitted non-organic agricultural ingredients;
c	The requirements in Section 22 Labelling, clause 22.1.3. shall be met.

20.2.2. Using organic and non-organic forms of the same ingredient in a single product is prohibited.

20.2.3. Water and salt may be used as ingredients in the production of organic products and are not included in the percentage calculations of organic ingredients.

20.2.4. Minerals (including trace elements) and vitamins shall not be used to fortify product unless their use is legally required or where severe dietary or nutritional deficiency can be demonstrated in the market to which the particular batch of product is destined.

20.2.5. Preparations of micro-organisms and enzymes commonly used in food processing may be used, with the exception of genetically engineered micro- organisms and their products.

20.2.6. For the production of organic micro-organisms for processed food and feed, only organically produced substrate shall be used.

20.3. Processing Methods

General Principle

Organic processing and handling provide the consumer with supplies of organic products without compromise to the integrity of the products and protects the environment.

Requirements:

20.3.1. Techniques used to process organic products shall be biological, physical, and mechanical in nature. Any additives, processing aids, or other material must be organically produced or appear in Appendix 4 Table 1 and shall be used in accordance with noted restrictions.

South African guidelines	
The following processes may be used:	
a	Mechanical and physical;
b	Biological;
c	Smoking;
d	Extraction;
e	Precipitation;
f	Filtration;
g	Distillation;
h	Microwaving.

20.3.2. Substances and techniques shall not be used that:

a Reconstitute properties lost by the processing and storage of organic products;

b Conceal negligent processing;

c Or may otherwise be misleading as to the true nature of these products. Water may be used for re-hydration or reconstitution.

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20.3.3. Solvents used to extract organic products shall be either organically produced or food grade substances that appear in Appendix 4, Table 1 consistent with the annotation.

20.3.4. Irradiation is not permitted for any ingredient or the final product.

20.3.5. Filtration equipment shall not contain asbestos or utilize techniques or substances that may contaminate the product. Filtration agents and adjuvants are considered processing aids and therefore must appear in Appendix 4.

20.3.6. The following conditions of storage are permitted (for allowed substances in these conditions, see Appendix 4):

a Controlled atmosphere;

b Temperature control;

c Drying;

d Humidity regulation.

20.3.7. Intentional manufacture or use of manufactured nanomaterials in organic products is prohibited.

20.3.8. Equipment surfaces and utensils that might come into contact with organic products shall be free of manufactured nanomaterials, unless there is verified absence of contamination risk.

20.4. Pest and Disease Control

General Principle

Organic products are protected from pests and diseases by the use of good manufacturing practices that include proper cleaning, sanitation and hygiene, without the use of chemical pest control treatments or irradiation.

Requirements:

20.4.1. Handlers and processors shall manage pests and shall use the following methods according to these priorities:

a Preventative methods such as disruption, elimination of habitat and access to facilities;

b Mechanical, physical and biological methods, including visual detection, sound, ultra-sound, light and UV-light, temperature control, controlled atmosphere and diatomaceous earth.

c Substances according to the Appendices of this Standard;

d Substances (other than pesticides) used in traps.

20.4.2. Prohibited pest control practices include, but are not limited to, the following substances and methods:

a Pesticides not contained in Appendix 3;

b Fumigation with ethylene oxide, methyl bromide, aluminium phosphide or other substance not contained in Appendix 4;

c Ionizing radiation / irradiation / radurisation.

20.4.3. The direct use or application of a prohibited method or material renders that product no longer organic. The operator shall take necessary precautions to prevent contamination, including the removal of organic products and related packaging materials from the storage or processing facility, and measures to decontaminate

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the equipment or facilities. Application of prohibited substances to equipment or facilities shall not contaminate organic product handled or processed therein. Application of prohibited substances to equipment or facilities shall not compromise the organic integrity of product handled or processed therein and shall be documented to attest this.

20.5. Packaging

General Principle

Organic product packaging has minimal adverse impacts on the product and on the environment.

Recommendation:

Polyvinyl chloride (PVC) and aluminium should be avoided for environmental reasons.

Requirements:

20.5.1. Operators shall not use packaging material that may contaminate organic products. This includes reused bags or containers that have been in contact with any substance likely to compromise the organic integrity. Packaging materials, and storage containers, or bins that contain a synthetic fungicide, preservative, fumigant, or manufactured nanomaterials are prohibited.

20.5.2. Operators shall demonstrate efforts to minimize packaging and / or choose packaging materials with minimum environmental impact. The total environmental impact of production, use and disposal of packaging must be considered.

20.6. Cleaning, Disinfecting, and Sanitizing of Processing Facilities

General Principle

Organic products are safe, and not contaminated by substances used to clean, disinfect and / or sanitize the processing facilities.

Requirements:

20.6.1. Operators shall take all necessary precautions to protect organic products against contamination by substances prohibited in organic farming and handling, pests, disease-causing organisms, and foreign substances.

20.6.2. Water and substances that appear in Appendix 4, Table 2, may be used as equipment cleansers and equipment disinfectants that may come into direct contact with the product. (Note: this clause does not preclude other terminal sanitizers to be used, as the list is simply indicative.)

20.6.3. Operations that use other cleaners, sanitizers, and disinfectants on product contact surfaces shall use them in a way that does not contaminate the product. The operator shall perform an intervening event between the use of any cleaner, sanitizer, or disinfectant and the contact of organic product with that surface sufficient to prevent residual contamination of that organic product:

South African specific	
Intervening events:	
a	A flush with organic products that may not be sold as organic;
b	Adequate time for the substance to volatilize.
NOTE: SANS 1828 and SANS 1853 give details on the requirements and safety of cleaning chemicals, disinfectants and detergent-disinfectants used in the food industry.	

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SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

21. WINE MAKING

General Principle

Organic wine is made from certified organic grapes using oenological techniques and substances authorised for organic wine making.

Recommendations

The use of sulphur dioxide should be limited as much as possible and not exceed limits set hereunder, unless specific circumstances prevail and authorisation to exceed these limits is granted by the certification body.

Requirements

21.1. Wine production shall be according to the rules for organic processing.

21.2. The only products and substances authorised for use in preparing organic products of the wine sector are listed in Appendix 7, together with their uses and conditions of use.

21.3. Products of the wine sector shall be produced from organic raw materials. This includes grapes. Other agricultural inputs that should be derived from organic raw material if available are set out in Appendix 7

21.4. The use of the following oenological practices, processes and treatments is prohibited:

a Partial concentration through cooling;

b Elimination of sulphur dioxide by physical processes;

c Electrodialysis treatment to ensure the tartaric stabilisation of the wine;

d Partial dealcoholisation of wine;

e Treatment with cation exchangers to ensure the tartaric stabilisation of the wine.

21.5. The use of the following oenological practices, processes and treatments is permitted under the following conditions:

a For heat treatments, the temperature shall not exceed 70 °C;

b For centrifuging and filtration with or without an inert filtering agent, the size of the pores shall be not smaller than 0,2 micrometres.

21.6. The maximum use of sulphur dioxide for different wines is set out in Appendix 7. However, if there are exceptional climatic conditions in a given harvest year, which lead to deterioration of the sanitary status of organic grapes in a specific geographical area because of severe bacterial attacks or fungal attacks, the winemaker may seek permission to use more sulphur dioxide than in normal years to obtain a comparable final product. Wine-makers will be required to keep documentary evidence of the use of this exception.

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SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

22. LABELLING

22.1. General

General Principle

Organic products are clearly and accurately labelled as organic.

Requirements

22.1.1. Products produced in accordance with this Standard may be labelled as organic.

22.1.2. Labels must identify the following:

a The person or company legally responsible for the product

b The body that assures conformity to the applicable organic standard.

22.1.3. Processed products shall be labelled according to the following minimum requirements:

a Where 95 to 100% of the ingredients (by weight) are organic, the product may be labelled as "organic".

b Where less than 95% but not less than 70% of the ingredients (by weight) are organic, the product cannot be labelled as "organic", but phrases such as "made with organic ingredients" can be used, provided the proportion of organic ingredients is clearly stated.

c Where less than 70% of the ingredients (by weight) are organic, the product cannot be labelled "organic", nor bear phrases such as "made with organic ingredients" on the package front, nor bear any certification body seal, national logo, or other identifying mark which represents organic certification of a product or product ingredients, but individual ingredients may be called "organic" in the ingredients list.

Notes on calculating percentages:

Water and salt are not included in the percentage calculations of organic ingredients.

22.1.4. All ingredients of a multi-ingredient product shall be listed on the product label in order of their weight percentage. It shall be apparent which ingredients are of organic certified origin and which are not. All additives shall be listed as per national legislation. If herbs and / or spices constitute less than 2% of the total weight of the product, they may be listed as "spices" or "herbs" without stating the percentage.

22.1.5. "In-conversion" ingredients may be used in multi-ingredient food. However, the ingredient list must identify their status and the total percentages of "in- conversion", organic and non-organic ingredients on a dry matter basis.

22.1.6. Multi-component products, live or unprocessed (such as vegetable boxes) may be sold or marketed as organic only if all the components are organic.

South African specific
22.1.7. A registered distinctive mark, indicating that that the products are covered by the inspection scheme of an ACB or PGS shall appear on the labelling of organically produced products: Provided that, subject to the

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provisions of the Scope of this Standard (Section A – 2.3.), no label of a product may refer to organic production methods without indicating the ACB or PGS' distinctive mark.

22.1.8. The label for in-conversion products shall be clearly distinguishable from the label for organic products. Only single ingredient plant products may be labelled as "in-conversion".

South African specific
22.1.9. For products which are certified as "in-conversion," since they have been under full organic management for between twelve and 36 months, the SAOSO logo may be used, but it must be clearly accompanied by the wording "Organic-in-Conversion," where the lettering of each word is of the same font and font size.

SAOSO specific
22.1.10. Products certified by SAOSO approved Participatory Guarantee Systems shall always display the words "Organic - PGS certified" on labelling and in advertising. In outlets were products that are labelled "Organic – PGS certified" are sold notices shall be posted that inform customers of the meaning of the words. PGS suppliers shall supply such notices.

South African specific	
22.1.11.	Products covered by these standards which are not in final packaging may be transported to other premises only in appropriate packaging or containers which are adequately labelled and identified to include all of the following:
a	The name and address of the person responsible for the production or preparation of the products.
b	The name of the product.
c	The certification carried by the product.
d	An indication specifying that the product is covered by the regular inspection arrangements of an ACB or PGS.

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SECTION B

DEFINITIONS, GENERAL PRINCIPLES, RECOMMENDATIONS AND STANDARDS

23. SOCIAL JUSTICE

General Principle

Social justice and social rights are an integral part of organic agriculture and processing. The fairness principle of organic agriculture emphasizes that those involved in organic agriculture should conduct human relationships in a manner that ensures fairness at all levels and to all parties involved.

Recommendation:

Operators should positively and actively encourage the collective organization of their employees or contracted smallholders.

Permanent employees and their families should have access to education, transportation and health services.

Operators should respect the rights of indigenous peoples and should not use or exploit land whose inhabitants or farmers have been or are being impoverished, dispossessed, colonized, expelled, exiled or killed, or which is currently in dispute regarding legal or customary local rights to its use or ownership.

Organic operations should make a positive social and cultural contribution over and above legal obligations. This could be in one or several of the following areas:

a Health and nutrition

b Education and training

c Research and innovation

d Supporting the local and wider community

e Enhancing rural development.

Requirements:

23.1. Production that violates human rights and social justice requirements in this chapter cannot be declared organic.

23.2. Operators shall not violate indigenous land rights

23.3. Operators shall not use forced or involuntary labour or apply any pressure such as retaining part of the workers' wages, property or documents.

23.4. Operators shall not interfere with the right of their employees, suppliers, farmers and contractors to organize and to bargain collectively, free from interference, intimidation and retaliation.

23.5. Operators shall provide their employees and contractors equal opportunity and treatment and shall not act in a discriminatory way.

23.6. Operators shall have a disciplinary procedure with a system of warning before any suspension or dismissal. Workers dismissed shall be given full details of reasons for dismissal.

23.7. Employees shall be granted the right to take at least one day off after six consecutive days of work. Operators shall not require workers to work more than the contracted hours and the national or

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regional sectorial legislation. Overtime shall be remunerated in the form of supplementary payments or time off in lieu.

23.8. Operators shall never require an employee to work who is ill or requiring medical attention and shall not sanction an employee for the sole fact of missing work due to illness.

23.9. Operators shall not use child labour. For the purpose of this Standard, all people under 15 are considered children.

Regional or other exception	
Children are allowed to experience work on their family's farm or business or a neighbouring farm provided that:	
a	Such work is not dangerous or hazardous to their health and safety;
b	It does not jeopardize the child's educational, moral, social, mental, spiritual and physical development;
c	Children are supervised by adults or have authorization from a legal guardian.

23.10. Operators shall pay employees wages and benefits that meet legal minimum requirements of the operation's jurisdiction or, in the absence of this minimum, the sectorial benchmark.

23.11. Operators shall provide written terms and conditions of employment to both permanent and temporary employees, in a language and presentation understandable to the worker. The terms and conditions must specify at least:

a Wages;

b Frequency and method of payment;

c Location, type and hours of work;

d Recognition of workers' freedom of association;

e Disciplinary procedure;

f Health and safety procedure;

g Eligibility and terms of overtime, holiday pay, sickness benefit and other benefits such as maternity and paternity leave; and

h Worker's right to terminate employment.

Operators shall ensure that the workers understand the terms of their employment contract. Operators shall respect the terms of the contract in good faith, including timely payment of wages.

Regional or other exception	
Oral mutual agreements on the terms and conditions of employment are sufficient in cases where:	
a	The operator is unable to write;
b	Workers are hired for periods of less than 6 days;
c	Emergency labour is needed to address unpredictable problems.

23.12. Operators shall ensure adequate access to potable water.

23.13. Operators shall provide appropriate safety training and equipment to protect workers from noise, dust, sunlight and exposure to chemicals or other hazards in all production and processing operations.

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23.14. Operators shall provide residential employees with habitable housing and access to potable water; to sanitary and cooking facilities and to basic medical care. If families reside on the operation, the operator shall also enable access to basic medical care for family members and to school for children.

23.15. Operators shall comply with minimum national social requirements in the countries of operation

23.16. Operators with more than 10 employees must have a written employment policy and maintain records to demonstrate full compliance with the requirements of this section. Workers will have access to their own files.

23.17. Requirements in this section apply equally to all workers on the operation regardless of how they are employed (e.g., direct employment, employment agencies, labour contractors and employment brokers.) except for subcontractors performing non-production core business functions such as plumbing, machine repair, or electrical work.

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SECTION B

APPENDIX 1

CRITERIA FOR THE EVALUATION OF INPUTS, ADDITIVES AND PROCESSING AIDS FOR ORGANIC PRODUCTION AND PROCESSING

General Principles

Organic production and processing systems are based on the use of natural, biological, renewable, and regenerative resources. Organic agriculture maintains soil fertility primarily through the recycling of organic matter. Nutrient availability is primarily dependent on the activity of soil organisms. Pests, diseases, and weeds are managed primarily through cultural practices. Organic livestock are nourished primarily through organically produced feed and forage and are kept in living conditions that allow for natural behaviour and avoidance of stress. Organic foods and other products are made from organically produced ingredients that are processed primarily by biological, mechanical, and physical means.

Input Lists

The following Appendices contain lists of the inputs, additives, processing aids, and other substances that are allowed for use in organic production, handling, and processing under this Standard. These lists will be amended based on a review by the Standards Committee, taking into account the below criteria for evaluation of inputs.

Production Input Criteria

Inputs used in organic production are consistent with the principles of organic farming outlined in the relevant chapters of the IFOAM Standard and are evaluated against criteria based upon the Precautionary Principle:

> '*When an activity raises threats of harm to human health or the environment, precautionary measures should be taken even if some cause-and-effect relationships are not fully established scientifically. In this context the proponent of an activity, rather than the public, should bear the burden of proof.'*
>
> *'The process of applying the Precautionary Principle must be open, informed and democratic and must include potentially affected parties. It must also involve an examination of the full range of alternatives, including no action.'*

The criteria used to evaluate organic production inputs are based on the following principles:

Necessity and alternatives: Any input used is necessary for sustainable production, is essential to maintain the quantity and quality of the product and is the best available technology.

Source and manufacturing process: Organic production is based on the use of natural, biological, and renewable resources.

Environment: Organic production and processing is sustainable for the environment.

Human health: Organic techniques supports human health and food safety.

Quality: Organic production methods enable the production of quality products.

Social, Economic, and Ethical: Inputs used in organic production meet consumer perceptions and expectations without resistance or opposition. Organic production is socially just and economically sustainable, and organic methods respect cultural diversity and protect animal welfare.

Dossiers for a given substance must address these criteria based on the data requirements and decision rules stated in the criteria below and meet the criteria to be added to the Appendices.

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A. Crop and Livestock Criteria

The following criteria are applied to inputs that are used to evaluate dossiers submitted for crop production.

However, the current SAOSO / SANS Standard does not have a separate appendix for livestock inputs. See Section B – 5 Animal Husbandry 5.3, 5.5, 5.6 and Section B -Appendix 5 Substances for Pest and Disease Control and Disinfection in Livestock Housing and Equipment for livestock standards and inputs that may be used in organic livestock production.

1. Necessity and Alternatives

All dossiers shall document the necessity of the substance, its essential nature in organic production systems, and the availability of alternative methods, practices, and inputs.

1.1. The input is necessary to produce crops or livestock in sufficient quantity and of suitable quality; to cycle nutrients; to enhance biological activity; to provide a balanced animal diet; to protect crops and livestock from pests, parasites, and diseases; to regulate growth; and to maintain and improve soil quality.

1.2. A given substance shall be evaluated with reference to other available inputs or practices that may be used as alternatives to the substance.

1.3. Every input shall be evaluated in the context in which the product will be used (e.g., crop, volume, frequency of application, specific purpose).

2. Source and Manufacturing Process

All dossiers shall document sources and manufacturing processes.

2.1. Biological substances require a description of the source organism(s), a verifiable statement that they are not genetically engineered as defined in Section B – 1 Definitions, and the processes required to breed, culture, produce, multiply, extract, or otherwise prepare the substance for use. Naturally occurring plants, animals, fungi, bacteria and other organisms are generally allowed. Substances that undergo physical transformations, such as by mechanical processing, or biological methods, like composting, fermentation, and enzymatic digestion are also generally allowed. Limitations and prohibitions may be set based on consideration of the other criteria. Substances that are modified by chemical reaction are considered synthetic and therefore subject to protocol 2.3 below.

2.2. Natural non-renewable resources—such as mined minerals—require a description of the deposit or occurrence in nature. Non-renewable resources are generally restricted or limited in their use. They may be used as a supplement to renewable biological resources, provided they are extracted by physical and mechanical means, and are not rendered synthetic by chemical reaction. Inputs with high levels of natural environmental contaminants, such as heavy metals, radioactive isotopes, and salinity, may be prohibited or further restricted.

2.3. Synthetic substances from non-renewable resources are generally prohibited. Synthetic, nature-identical products that are not available in sufficient quantities and qualities in their natural form may be allowed, provided that all other criteria are satisfied.

2.4. Inputs that are extracted, recovered, or manufactured by means that are environmentally destructive may be restricted or prohibited.

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3. Environment

All dossiers shall document the substance's environmental impact.

3.1. The environmental impact of a substance includes, but is not limited to, the following parameters: Acute toxicity, persistence, degradability, areas of concentration; biological, chemical, and physical interactions with the environment, including known synergistic effects with other inputs used in organic production.

3.2. Effect of substance on the agro-ecosystem including soil quality and health; the effects of the substance on soil organisms; soil fertility and structure; crops and livestock.

3.3. Substances with high salt indexes, measured toxicity to non-target organisms, and persistent adverse effects may be prohibited or restricted in their use.

3.4. Inputs used for crop production shall be considered for their impact on livestock and wildlife.

4. Human Health

All dossiers shall document the impacts of the substance on human health.

4.1. Documentation about human health includes but is not limited to: acute and chronic toxicity, half-lives, degradants, and metabolites. Substances reported to have adverse effects may be prohibited or restricted in their use to reduce potential risks to human health.

4.2. Dossiers shall document any human who might be exposed by all possible pathways, at every stage: workers and farmers who extract, manufacture, apply, or otherwise use the substance; neighbours who may be exposed through its release into the environment; and consumers exposed by ingestion of food- borne residues.

5. Quality

All dossiers shall document the substance's effect on product quality. Quality includes, but is not limited to, nutrition, flavour, taste, storage, and appearance of the raw product.

6. Social, Economic, and Ethical Considerations

All dossiers shall document the substance's social, economic, and cultural implications.

6.1. Social and economic implications include, but are not limited to, the impact of the substance on the communities where they are made and used, whether the use of the substance favours any economic structure and scale, and the historical use of the substance in traditional foods.

6.2. Inputs used for animal feed and livestock production shall be evaluated for their impact on animal health, welfare, and behaviour. Medications must either alleviate or prevent animal suffering. Animal inputs that cause suffering or have a negative influence on the natural behaviour or physical functioning of animals kept at the farm may be prohibited or restricted.

B. Processing and Handling Criteria

Introduction

These criteria apply to the evaluation of additives and processing aids. Substances used for technical, sensory, and dietary purposes are subject to these criteria. The criteria may also apply to substances in contact with the product. For processing, an input, non-organic ingredient, additive, or processing aid shall be essential to maintain

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or improve human health, environmental safety, animal welfare, product quality, production efficiency, consumer acceptance, ecological protection, biodiversity, or landscape. Carriers and preservatives used in the preparation of additives and processing aids must also be taken into consideration. The following aspects and criteria should be used to evaluate additives and processing aids in organic products. All of the criteria below shall be fully and positively documented in a dossier and review for an input to be allowed in organic processing.

1. Necessity and Alternatives

All dossiers shall document the necessity of the additive, processing aid, or carrier, its essential nature in organic processing and for the proposed application, and the availability of alternative methods, practices, and inputs. Each substance shall be evaluated with respect to its specific uses and applications and shall be added when it is demonstrated to be absolutely essential and necessary for the production of a specific product that is consistent with organic principles stated in the SAOSO / SANS Standard.

1.1.1. All dossiers shall take into consideration the technical feasibility of the following alternatives:

a Whole products that are organically produced according to the standard.

b Products that are organically produced and processed according to the standard.

c Purified products of raw materials of non-agricultural origin, e.g., salt.

d Purified products of raw materials of an agricultural origin that have not been organically produced and processed according to the standard but appear on Appendix 4.

1.2. If an ingredient is required to manufacture a processed product to independently established minimum technical specifications recognized by consumers, and no organic substitute is available, then a non-organic ingredient may be deemed essential.

1.3. A given additive, processing aid, or carrier shall be evaluated with reference to other available ingredients or techniques that may be used as alternatives to the substance.

1.4. A substance is considered essential if a processed product requires that substance in order to meet established standards of identity and governmental regulations.

2. Source and Manufacturing Process

All dossiers shall document the substance's sources and manufacturing processes.

2.1. Additives and processing aids from biological sources, such as fermentation cultures, enzymes, flavours, and gums must be derived from naturally occurring organisms by the use of biological, mechanical, and physical methods. Non- organic forms are allowed in organic products only if there are no organic sources.

2.2. Natural non-renewable resources such as salt and mined minerals must be obtained by physical and mechanical means and are not rendered synthetic by chemical reaction. Dossiers must document and meet Food Chemical Codex specifications for natural contaminants, such as heavy metals, radioactive isotopes, and salinity, and may be prohibited or restricted based on unacceptable levels of contamination.

2.3. Synthetic nature-identical products that are not available in sufficient quantities and qualities in their natural form may be allowed provided all other criteria are satisfied.

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2.4. Synthetic substances from non-renewable resources are generally prohibited as additives and processing aids.

3. Environment

All dossiers shall document the substance's environmental impact. Documentation for environmental impact: the release of any harmful waste stream or by-products from both manufacturing and use in processing. Additives and processing aids that result in toxic by-products or polluting waste may be restricted or prohibited. This includes persistence, degradation, and areas of concentration.

4. Human Health

All dossiers shall document the impacts of the substance on human health.

4.1. Documentation about human health includes but is not limited to: acute and chronic toxicity, allergenicity, half-lives, degradants, and metabolites. Substances reported to have adverse effects may be prohibited or restricted in their use to reduce potential risks to human health.

4.2. Dossiers shall document any human who might be exposed by all possible pathways: workers and farmers who manufacture, apply, or otherwise use the substance; neighbours who may be exposed through release into the environment; and consumers exposed by ingestion of food-borne residues.

4.3. SAOSO considers only processing aids and additives evaluated by the Joint FAO/ WHO Expert Committee on Food Additives (JECFA) of the Codex Alimentarius.

a A food additive shall have an Acceptable Daily Intake (ADI) level that is either 'not specified' or 'not limited' to qualify for use without limitation.

b A food additive with any other status shall either be prohibited or have specific use restrictions to limit dietary exposure.

c Evaluation of food additives shall also take into account known allergenicity and immunological responses.

4.4. Information about the practical daily intake of the substance by several groups of humans should be taken into account. It should be demonstrated that no group has a normal intake that is higher than the accepted ADI.

5. Quality (in processed products)

5.1. All dossiers shall document the substance's effect on overall product quality, including, but not limited to, nutrition, flavour, taste, storage, and appearance.

5.2. Additives and processing aids shall not detract from the nutritional quality of the product.

5.3. A substance shall not be used solely or primarily as a preservative, to create, recreate or improve characteristics such as flavours, colours, or textures, or to restore or improve nutritive value lost during processing, except where the replacement of nutrients is required by law.

5.4. Non-organic ingredients, additives, or processing aids used to process organic products shall not compromise the authenticity or overall quality of the product or deceive the consumer of the product's value.

5.5. Each additive shall be evaluated with respect to its specific uses and applications without preference for any specific techniques or equipment and shall be added to the list only when it is demonstrated to be

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absolutely essential and necessary for the formulation and production of a specific product that is consistent with organic principles stated in the Standard.

6. Social, Economic, and Ethical Considerations

6.1. All dossiers shall document the substance's social, economic, and ethical implications.

6.2. These are not limited to adverse impacts on communities caused by the manufacture and use of the substance, whether certain economic structures or scales are favoured by the use of the processing aid; and the historical use of the additive or processing aid in traditional products.

6.3. An input might be reasonably considered to be incompatible with organic production in situations where there is new scientific data about the impact of the substance on the environment or human health.

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SECTION B

APPENDIX 2

FERTILIZERS AND SOIL CONDITIONERS

SUBSTANCES DESCRIPTION, COMPOSITIONAL REQUIREMENTS	CONDITIONS FOR USE
I. PLANT AND ANIMAL ORIGIN	
Farmyard manure, slurry and urine	Shall not constitute the main source of nitrogen in the absence of complimentary and additional nitrogen generating practices on farm and shall not be from conventional intensive livestock production systems without prior permission from the control body Coming from extensive livestock farming. If sourced from intensive livestock farming or not sourced from organic production systems, then the need for use thereof shall be motivated to the certification body, and it shall be composted. Forbidden if from factory farming origin.
South African specific	
Farmyard manure, slurry and urine	Manure applications should not be the primary source of nitrogen. See Section B – Appendix 6 Minimum Surface Areas Indoors and Outdoors and other Characteristics of Housing in the Different Species and Types of Production for the density of livestock for the equivalent of 170 Kg nitrogen per hectare per year.
Guano	
South African specific	
Source separated human excrement	Specifically prohibited.
Vermicastings	
Blood meal, meat meal, bone, bone meal	
Hoof and horn meal, feather meal, fish and shell products, wool, hide, fur, hair, dairy products	
Biodegradable processing by-products, plant or animal origin, e.g., by-products of food, feed, oilseed, brewery, distillery or textile processing	Free of significant contaminants; or composted before bringing onto organic land and confirmed free of significant contaminants
Crop residues and plant materials, mulch, green manure, straw	
Wood, bark, sawdust, wood shavings, wood ash, wood charcoal	Only if not chemically treated
Seaweed and seaweed products	As far as obtained by: i) physical processes including dehydration, freezing and grinding; ii) extraction with water or potassium hydroxide solutions, provided that the minimum amount of solvent necessary is used for extraction;

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	(iii) fermentation.
Peat (prohibited for soil conditioning)	Excluding synthetic additives; permitted only in horticulture (floriculture, nursery plants, potting mixes).
Plant preparations and extracts	
Compost made from ingredients listed in this appendix,	
Spent mushroom waste, humus from worms and insects,	
South African specific	
Urban composts and household wastes from separated sources which are monitored for contamination	Maximum concentrations in milligrams per kilogram (mg/kg) of dry matter: a) cadmium: 0,7; b) copper: 70; c) nickel: 25; d) lead: 45; e) zinc: 200; f) mercury: 0,4; g) chromium (total): 70; h) chromium (VI): 0
II. MINERAL ORIGIN	
Calcareous and magnesium amendments: Limestone, gypsum, marl, maerl, chalk, sugar beet lime	
Calcium chloride	
Magnesium rock, kieserite and Epsom salt (magnesium sulphate)	
Other non-synthetic calcareous and magnesium amendments	
Clay (e.g., bentonite, perlite, vermiculite, zeolite)	
Mineral potassium (e.g., sulphate of potash, muriate of potash, kainite, sylvanite, patentkali)	Shall be obtained by physical procedures but not enriched by chemical processes
Phosphates in non-synthetic form (e.g., rock phosphate, colloidal phosphate, apatite)	Cadmium content less than or equal to 90 mg/kg of P_2O_5
Pulverized rock, stone meal, crushed stone.	
Sodium chloride	
Sulphur	
Trace elements, e.g.: boric acid, sodium borate, calcium borate, borethanolamin, cobalt-acetate, cobalt-sulphate, copper oxide, copper sulphate, copper hydroxide, copper silicate, copper carbonate, copper citrate, ferric oxide, ferric sulphate, ferrous sulphate, iron citrate, iron sulphate, or iron tartrate manganous oxide, manganese sulphate and manganese carbonate selenic acid, selenic acid, sodium molybdate, molybdic oxide zinc carbonate, zinc oxide, zinc silicate, and zinc sulphate	Use restricted to cases where soil/plant nutrient deficiency is documented by soil or tissue testing or diagnosed by an independent expert. Micronutrients in either chloride or nitrate forms are prohibited. Micronutrients may not be used as a defoliant, herbicide, or desiccant.
III. MICROBIOLOGICAL	
Biodegradable processing by-products of microbial origin, e.g., by-products of brewery or distillery processing	

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Microbiological preparations based on naturally occurring organisms	
IV. OTHERS	
Biodynamic preparations	
Calcium lignosulfonate	

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SECTION B

APPENDIX 3

CROP PROTECTANTS AND GROWTH REGULATORS

SUBSTANCES DESCRIPTION, COMPOSITIONAL REQUIREMENTS	CONDITIONS FOR USE
I. PLANT AND ANIMAL ORIGIN	
Algal preparations	As far as obtained by: i) physical processes including dehydration, freezing and grinding; ii) extraction with water or potassium hydroxide solutions, provided that the minimum amount of solvent necessary is used for extraction; iii) fermentation.
Animal preparations and oils	
Beeswax	
Chitin nematicides (natural origin)	Not processed by acid hydrolysis
Coffee grounds	
Corn gluten meal	
Dairy products (e.g., milk, casein)	
Gelatine	
Lecithin (unbleached)	
Natural acids (e.g., vinegar)	
Neem oil (*Azadirachta indica*), cold pressed, unrefined, concentration of Azadirachtin not to exceed 3000 ppm	
Plant oils (e.g. mint oil, pine oil, and caraway oil)	Insecticide, acaricide, fungicide and sprout inhibitor
Plant preparations	
Plant based repellents	
Propolis	
Pyrethrum (*Chrysanthemum cinerariafolium*)	The synergist Piperonyl butoxide is prohibited.
Quassia (*Quassia amara*)	
Rotenone root powder (*Derris elliptica, Lonchocarpus spp. Tephrosia spp.*)	Not near waterways. Subject to approval by the CB
Ryania (*Ryania speciosa*)	
Sabadilla	
II. MINERAL ORIGIN	
Calcium chloride	
Clay (e.g., bentonite, perlite, vermiculite, zeolite)	
Copper salts (e.g., copper sulphate, copper hydroxide, copper oxychloride, copper octanoate)	Max 6 kg Cu/ha per year, on a rolling average basis. For perennial crops - provided that the 6 kg copper limit can be exceeded in a given year provided that the average quantity actually used over a 5-year period consisting of that year and of the four preceding years does not exceed 6 kg.
Diatomaceous earth	
Light mineral oils (paraffinic)	
Calcium polysulfide (Lime sulphur)	
Potassium bicarbonate	
Calcium hydroxide (hydrated lime)	For application on aerial plant parts only

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Silicates (e.g., diatomaceous earth, sodium silicates, quartz)	
Sodium bicarbonate	
Sulphur	
III. MICROORGANISMS	
Fungal preparations (e.g., *Metarhizium, Trichoderma*)	
Bacterial preparations (e.g., *Bacillus thuringiensis*, Spinosad)	
South African specific	
Effective Microorganisms	
Korean Natural Farming preparations, Biofertilizers, and other naturally derived preparations.	Ingredients limited to those listed in Annexures 2 and 3.
Viral preparations (e.g., granulosis virus)	
Release of parasites, predators and sterilized insects	
IV. OTHERS	
Biodynamic preparations	
Carbon dioxide	Shall not be the result of burning fuel solely to produce carbon dioxide; allowed only as a by-product of other processes.
Ethyl alcohol	
Homeopathic and Ayurvedic preparations	
Iron phosphates (for use as molluscicide)	
Sea salt and salty water	
Soft soap (potassium soap)	
V. TRAPS, BARRIERS, REPELLENTS	
Physical methods (e.g., chromatic traps, mechanical traps)	
Mulches, nets	
Pheromones in traps and dispensers only	

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APPENDIX 4, TABLE 1

LIST OF APPROVED ADDITIVES AND PROCESSING / POST-HARVEST HANDLING AIDS

Substances of certified organic origin must be used if commercially available. If organic sources are not available, natural sources must be used if commercially available. Only if organic and natural sources are not available, synthetic forms of the substances below may be used.				
INS = International Numbering System				
PROC. & Post Har. Han. AID = Processing and Post-Harvest Handling Aid				
Additives may contain carriers, which shall be evaluated				
INS	**PRODUCT**	**ADDITIVE**	**PROC. & Post Har. Han. AID**	**LIMITATION / NOTE**
INS 170	Calcium carbonate	X	X	Not for colouring
INS 184	Tannic acid		X	Filtration aid for wine
INS 220	Sulphur dioxide	X		Only for wine
INS 224	Potassium metabisulphite	X		Only for wine
INS 270	Lactic acid	X	X	
INS 290	Carbon dioxide	X	X	
INS 296	L-malic acid	X	X	
INS 300	Ascorbic acid	X		
INS 306	Tocopherols, mixed natural concentrates	X		
INS 322	Lecithin	X	X	Obtained without bleaches
INS 330	Citric acid	X	X	
INS 331	Sodium citrates	X		
INS 332	Potassium citrates	X		
INS 333	Calcium citrates	X		
INS 334	Tartaric acid	X	X	Only for wine
INS 335	Sodium tartrate	X	X	
INS 336	Potassium tartrate	X	X	
INS 341	Mono calcium phosphate	X		Only for “raising flour”
INS 342	Ammonium phosphate	X		Restricted to 0.3 gm/l in wine
INS 400	Alginic acid	X		
INS 401	Sodium alginate	X		
INS 402	Potassium alginate	X		
INS 406	Agar	X		
INS 407	Carrageenan	X		
INS 410	Locust bean gum	X		
INS 412	Guar gum	X		
INS 413	Tragacanth gum	X		
INS 414	Arabic gum	X		
INS 415	Xanthan gum	X		
INS 428	Gelatine		X	
INS 440	Pectin	X		Unmodified
INS 500	Sodium carbonates	X	X	
INS 501	Potassium carbonates	X	X	
INS 503	Ammonium carbonates	X		Only for cereal products, confectionery, cakes and biscuits
INS 504	Magnesium carbonates	X		

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INS 508	Potassium chloride	X		
INS 509	Calcium chloride	X	X	
INS 511	Magnesium chloride	X	X	Only for soybean products
INS 513	Sulfuric acid	X	X	As processing aid for pH adjustment of water during sugar processing. As additive for wine and apple cider production
INS 516	Calcium sulphate	X		For soybean products, confectionery and in bakers' yeast
INS 517	Ammonium sulphate	X		Only for wine, restricted to 0.3 mg/l
INS 524	Sodium hydroxide	X	X	For sugar processing and for the surface treatment of traditional bakery products
INS 526	Calcium hydroxide	X	X	Food additive for maize tortilla flour Processing aid for sugar
INS 551	Silicon dioxide (amorphous)		X	
INS 553	Talc		X	
INS 558	Bentonite		X	Only for fruit and vegetable products
INS 901	Beeswax		X	
INS 903	Carnauba wax		X	
INS 938	Argon	X		
INS 941	Nitrogen	X	X	
INS 948	Oxygen	X	X	
	Ethylene		X	De-greening of citrus and ripening
	Activated carbon		X	
	Casein		X	Only for wine
	Cellulose		X	
	Diatomaceous earth		X	
	Ethanol		X	
	Isinglass		X	Only for wine
	Kaolin		X	
	Perlite		X	
	Plant and animal oils		X	For extraction only
	Preparations of bark		X	Only for sugar

	Flavouring Agents
	Operators may use:
	• organic flavouring extracts (including volatile oils), and, if not available,
	• natural flavouring preparations approved by the control body. Such approval shall include assessment that natural flavours shall meet the following criteria:
a	the sources are plant, animal or mineral;
b	the process of production is in accordance with a recognized organic standard;
c	they are produced by means of solvents such as vegetal oils, water, ethanol, carbon dioxide and mechanical and physical processes.
	Preparations of Micro-organisms and Enzymes for use in food processing (see 7.2.5)
	These may be used as ingredient or processing aids with approval from the control body:
	• Organic certified micro-organisms
	• Preparations of micro-organisms
	• Enzymes and enzyme preparations

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APPENDIX 4 TABLE 2:

INDICATIVE LIST OF EQUIPMENT CLEANSERS AND EQUIPMENT DISINFECTANTS

PRODUCT	LIMITATION/NOTE
Acetic acid	
Alcohol, ethyl (ethanol)	
Alcohol, isopropyl (isopropanol)	
Calcium hydroxide (slaked lime)	
Calcium hypochlorite	An intervening event or action must occur to eliminate risks of contamination
Calcium oxide (quicklime)	
Calcium oxychloride, Calcium chloride, and Calcium hydroxide (Chloride of lime)	
Chlorine dioxide	An intervening event or action must occur to eliminate risks of contamination
Citric acid	
Formic acid	
Hydrogen peroxide	
Lactic acid	
Natural essences of plants	
Oxalic acid	
Ozone	
Peracetic acid	
Phosphoric acid	Only for dairy equipment
Plant extracts	
Potassium soap	An intervening event or action must occur to eliminate risks of contamination
Sodium carbonate	
Sodium hydroxide (caustic soda)	An intervening event or action must occur to eliminate risks of contamination
Sodium hypochlorite	An intervening event or action must occur to eliminate risks of contamination
Sodium soap	An intervening event or action must occur to eliminate risks of contamination

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APPENDIX 5:

SUBSTANCES FOR PEST AND DISEASE CONTROL AND DISINFECTION IN LIVESTOCK HOUSING AND EQUIPMENT

PRODUCT
Alkali carbonates
Calcium oxide (lime, quicklime)
Potassium hydroxide (Caustic potash)
Sodium hydroxide (Caustic soda)
Citric acid, peracetic acid, formic acid, lactic acid, oxalic acid and acetic acid
Cleaning and disinfection products for teats and milking facilities
Ethanol and isopropanol
Hydrogen peroxide
Iodine
Calcium hydroxide (Milk of lime slack lime, picking lime, hydrated lime, slaked lime)
Natural essences of plants
Nitric acid (dairy equipment)
Phosphoric acid (dairy equipment)
Potassium and sodium soap
Sodium carbonate
Sodium hypochlorite (e.g., as liquid bleach)
Water and steam

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SECTION B

SOUTH AFRICAN specific

APPENDIX 6a:

NUMBER OF ANIMALS PER HA EQUIVALENT TO 170 KG N/HA/YEAR

Source: EU 2092/91

Maximum number of animals per ha Class or species	Maximum number of animals per ha equivalent to 170 kg N/ha/year
Equines over six months old	2
Calves for fattening	5
Other bovine animals less than one year old	5
Male bovine animals from one to less than two years old	3,3
Female bovine animals from one to less than two years old	3,3
Male bovine animals two years old or over	2
Breeding heifers	2,5
Heifers for fattening	2,5
Dairy cows	2
Cull dairy cows	2
Other cows	2,5
Female breeding rabbits	100
Ewes	13,3
Goats	13,3
Piglets	74
Breeding sows	6,5
Pigs for fattening	14
Other pigs	14
Table chickens	580
Laying hens	230

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SECTION B

SOUTH AFRICAN specific

APPENDIX 6b:

MINIMUM SURFACE AREAS INDOORS AND OUTDOORS AND OTHER CHARACTERISTICS OF HOUSING FOR THE DIFFERENT SPECIES AND TYPES OF PRODUCTION

Source: EU 2092/91

BOVINES, EQUIDAE OVINES AND PORCINE (CATTLE, HORSES, SHEEP, GOATS AND PIGS)			
	INDOOR AREA (net area available to animals		OUTDOOR AREA (exercise area, excluding pasturage
	Live weight minimum (kg)	m²/head	m²/head
Breeding and fattening Bovine and Equidae	Up to 100	1.5	1.1
	Up to 200	2.5	1.9
	Up to 350	4.0	3.0
	Over to 350	5 with a minimum of 1 m²/100 kg	3.7 with a minimum of 0.75 m²/100 kg
Dairy cows		6	4.5
Bulls for breeding		10	30
Sheep and goats		1.5	2.5
		0.35 per lamb/kid	0.5 per lamb/kid
Farrowing sows with piglets up to 40 days		7.5 sow	2.5
Fattening pigs	Up to 50	0.8	0.6
	Up to 85	1.1	0.8
	Up to 100	1.3	1
Piglets over 40 days	Up to 30 kg	0.6	0.4
Brood pigs		2.5 female	1.9
		6.0 male	8.0

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POULTRY				
	INDOOR AREA (net area available to animals)			OUTDOOR AREA (m² of area available in rotation / head)
	No animals / m²	cm perch / animal	nest	
Laying hens	6	18	8 laying hens per nest or in case of common nest 120 cm²/bird	4 provided that the limit of 170 kg of N / ha / year is not exceeded
Fattening poultry (in fixed housing)	10 with a maximum of 21 kg live weight / m²	20 (for guinea fowl only)		4 broilers and guinea fowl 4,5ducks 10 turkeys 15 geese In all the species mentioned above the limit of 170 kg of N / ha / year must not be exceeded
Fattening poultry in mobile housing	16 in mobile poultry houses with a maximum of 30 kg live weight / m²			2,5, provided that the limit of 170 kg of N / ha / year is not exceeded

POULTRY BARNS MINIMUM EXIT NUMBERS AND SIZE (Ref Canada Organic Regime, CAN/CGSB-32.310)				
Poultry	**Combined width of pop-holes**	**Minimum width of each pop-hole**	**Minimum height**	**Minimum number**
Layers	2 m / 1000 hens	50 cm	35 cm	2
Broilers	1 m / 1000 birds OR all birds within 15 m of an exit	50 cm	35 cm	2
Turkeys	2 m / 1000 birds	150 cm	75 cm	2

MINIMUM INDOOR AND OUTDOOR SPACE REQUIREMENTS FOR RABBITS (Ref Canada Organic Regime, CAN/CGSB-32.310)				
Rabbits	**Indoor space**	**Outdoor – runs and concrete exercise areas**	**Outdoor – pasture**	**Mobile pens**
From weaning to slaughter	0.3 m^2 / head	2 m^2 / head	5 m^2 / head	0.4 m^2 / head
Pregnant does	0.5 m^2 / head	2 m^2 / head	5 m^2 / head	0.5 m^2 / head
Does and litters	0.7 m^2 / head	2 m^2 / head	Not applicable	0.4 m^2 / head in shelter 2.4 m^2 / head for grazing area
Bucks	0.3 m^2 / head	2 m^2 / head	5 m^2 / head	0.4 m^2 / head

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SECTION B

APPENDIX 7:

AUTHORISED OENOLOGICAL PRACTICES AND PROCESSES IN ORGANIC WINEMAKING

	Oenological practice	**Authorised products**	**Conditions of use** [(1)]	**Limits on use and Applications**
1	Aeration or oxygenation using gaseous oxygen	Air, Gaseous oxygen		
2	Heat treatments	Maximum temperature 70°C		
3	Centrifuging and filtration with or without an inert filtering agent	Perlite, Cellulose, Diatomaceous earths		Use of an agent must not leave undesirable residues in the treated product
4	Use of carbon dioxide, argon or nitrogen, either alone or combined, in order to create an inert atmosphere and to handle the product shielded from the air	Nitrogen, Carbon dioxide, Argon	Only with fresh grapes, grape must, partially fermented grape must, partially fermented grape must be obtained from raisined grapes, concentrated grape must and new wine still in fermentation and for the second alcoholic fermentation of all categories of sparkling wine.	Use in order to create an inert atmosphere and to handle the product shielded from the air.
5	Use of yeasts for wine production, whether dry or in wine suspension	Yeasts (if available, derived from organic raw material)		
6a	Use to encourage yeast development, with the possible addition of microcrystalline cellulose as an excipient: - addition of diammonium phosphate	Diammonium phosphate	Only with fresh grapes, grape must, partially fermented grape must, partially fermented grape must be obtained from raisined grapes, concentrated grape must and new wine still in fermentation and for the second alcoholic fermentation of all categories of sparkling wine.	No more than 1 g/l (expressed in salts) or 0,3 g/l for the second fermentation of sparkling wines.
6b	Use to encourage yeast development, with the possible addition of microcrystalline cellulose as an excipient:- addition of thiamine hydrochloride	Thiamine hydrochloride	Only with fresh grapes, grape must, partially fermented grape must, partially fermented grape must obtained from raisined grapes, concentrated grape must	No more than 0,6 mg/l (expressed in thiamine) for each treatment

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			and new wine still in fermentation and for the second alcoholic fermentation of all categories of sparkling wine.	
7	Use of sulphur dioxide, potassium bisulphite or potassium metabisulphite, also called potassium disulphite or potassium pyrosulphite	Sulphur dioxide, Potassium bisulphite or potassium metabisulphite		For red wines: (a) With residual sugar <2g/L: 100 mg/L; (b) With residual sugar >2g/L and < 5g/L: 120 mg/L (c) With residual sugar ≥ 5g/L: 170 mg/L For white and rosé wines: (d) With residual sugar <2g/L: 150 mg/L (e) With residual sugar >2g/L and < 5g/L: 170 mg/L (g) With residual sugar ≥ 5g/L: 220mg/L For liqueur wines: With residual sugar < 5g/L: 120 mg/L With residual sugar ≥ 5g/L: 170 mg/L For sparkling wines: Quality wines (Mèthode Cap Classique): 155 mg/L Other sparkling wines: 205 mg/L
8	Treatment with charcoal for oenological use		Only for musts and new wines still in fermentation, rectified concentrated grape must and white wines	No more than 100 g of dry product per hl
9	Clarification by means of one or more of the following substances for oenological use:	- edible gelatine, - plant proteins of wheat or peas, - isinglass, - egg albumin, - tannin, - casein and potassium caseinates, - bentonite,		The following substances should be derived from organic raw material if available: - Edible Gelatine, - Plant proteins of wheat or peas, - Isinglass, - Egg white albumen,

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		- silicon dioxide as a gel or colloidal solution, - pectolytic enzymes		- Tannins
10	Use of tartaric L(+) acid, or lactic acid for acidification purposes	Lactic acid, L(+) Tartaric acid	L(+) tartaric acid must be of agricultural origin and extracted specifically from wine products. It must also comply with purity criteria. Process to be carried out in a single operation if possible.	
11	Use of one or more of the following substances for deacidification purposes:	- neutral potassium tartrate - potassium bicarbonate - calcium carbonate, - L(+) tartaric acid	L(+) tartaric acid must be of agricultural origin and extracted specifically from wine products. It must also comply with purity criteria. Process to be carried out in a single operation if possible.	
12	Use of preparations from yeast cell walls	Yeasts, (if available, derived from organic raw material)		No more than 40 g/hl
13	Use of lactic bacteria	Lactic bacteria		
14	Addition of L ascorbic acid	L ascorbic acid		Maximum content in wine thus treated and placed on the market: 250 mg/l. The use limit is 250 mg/l for each treatment.
15	Use in dry wines of fresh lees which are sound and undiluted and contain yeasts resulting from the recent vinification of dry wine	Yeasts, (if available, derived from organic raw material)	For natural wines, sparkling wines and liqueur wines.	Quantities not exceeding 5 % of the volume of product treated
16	Bubbling using argon or nitrogen			
17	Addition of carbon dioxide	Carbon Dioxide	For partially fermented must for direct human consumption as such and for natural wines, aerated sparkling wines and aerated semi-sparkling wines.	In the case of still wines the maximum carbon dioxide content in the wine so treated and placed on the market is 3 g/l, while the excess pressure caused by the carbon dioxide must be less than 1 bar at a temperature of 20 °C

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18	Addition for wine stabilisation purposes	Citric acid	For partially fermented must for direct human consumption as such and for natural wines, liqueur wines, sparkling wines, and wines made from raisined grapes and overripe grapes.	Maximum content in wine thus treated and placed on the market: 1g/l
19	Addition of tannins	Tannins (derived from organic raw material, if available)	For partially fermented must for direct human consumption as such and for natural wines, liqueur wines, sparkling wines, and wines made from raisined grapes and overripe grapes.	
20	Addition of metatartaric acid	Meta-tartaric acid	For partially fermented must for direct human consumption as such and for natural wines, liqueur wines, sparkling wines, and wines made from raisined grapes and overripe grapes.	No more than 100 mg/l
21	Use of acacia	Acacia gum, derived from organic material if available (= gum arabic)	For partially fermented must for direct human consumption as such and for natural wines, liqueur wines, sparkling wines, and wines made from raisined grapes and overripe grapes.	
22	To assist the precipitation of tartaric salts, use of:	Potassium bitrate	For partially fermented must for direct human consumption as such and for natural wines, liqueur wines, sparkling wines, and wines made from raisined grapes and overripe grapes.	In the case of calcium tartrate, no more than 200 g/hl
23	To eliminate defects of taste or smell in the wine	Cupric citrate Also copper sulphate authorised until 31 July 2015	For partially fermented must for direct human consumption as such and for natural wines, liqueur wines, sparkling wines, and wines made from raisined grapes and overripe grapes.	No more than 1 g/hl, provided that the copper content of the product so treated does not exceed 1 mg/l

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24	For winemaking and ageing, including in the fermentation of fresh grapes and grape must	Oak chips	Chips (at least 95% of which will not pass through a 2 mm. mesh filter) only from the *Quercus* genus. In their natural state or heated but not having undergone combustion, nor undergone any other chemical, enzymatic or physical processes.	
25	Use of:	Potassium alginate	Only for the manufacture of all categories of sparkling and semi-sparkling wines obtained by fermentation in bottle and with the lees separated by disgorging.	
NOTE: (1) Unless otherwise stated, the practice or process described may be used for fresh grapes, grape must, partially fermented grape must, partially fermented grape must from raisined grapes, concentrated grape must, new wine still in fermentation, partially fermented grape must for direct human consumption, wine, all categories of sparkling wine, semi-sparkling wine, aerated semi-sparkling wine, liqueur wines, wines made from raisined grapes and wines made from over-ripened grapes.				

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SECTION C

APPENDIX A.

SAOSO ORGANIC LOGOS

1. Logo for use on products certified organic under a 3rd Party Certification scheme:



2. Logo for use on products endorsed as organic under a Participatory Guarantee Systems (PGS) scheme:



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SECTION C

APPENDIX B.

CRITERIA FOR APPROVAL OF PGS

This Appendix should be read alongside Appendix C. Procedure for Approval for Use of the South African Organic Sector Organisation (SAOSO) Organic PGS Endorsed Logo.

Each of the following criteria will be assessed by PGSSA in ways that are reflective of the diverse ways by which PGS aim to address the basic criteria: if there is a criterion that the PGS does not comply with for very justified reasons and it has an alternative and equivalent (equally effective) way to address the intent of the criteria, this equivalent mechanism can be considered acceptable. It should however be reported to PGSSA which will keep a compiled record of all "derogations based on equivalent mechanisms". PGSSA will forward the report of granted derogations to SAOSO minimum annually. This will serve for guaranteeing fairness and consistency in the assessments of PGS regionally, and for future improvement of these criteria:

a. The PGS is a participatory organization or structure, whereby producers (at minimum) and other stakeholders (desirable) participate voluntarily and transparently in the choice of the standard, the procedures for verification and sanctions, and the choice of people with specific responsibility in the PGS. Decisions regarding PGS procedures are made either in general assembly, regular group meetings (open to all participating producers), or by regularly elected producer (and consumer) representatives.

b. PGS implementation mechanisms are locally and culturally adapted and relevant and efforts are made to minimize paperwork needed for endorsement.

c. Participating producers take a public pledge to follow the standard and are subsequently subject to on- site reviews/assessments at minimum once a year to verify their continued compliance with the standard.

d. The PGS has developed a system for managing non-compliance, with clear consequences that are implemented, including suspending operators with serious non-compliances.

e. The PGS grants open and easy access to consumers, the public and any interested person to:

i. Its chosen standard;
ii. Its list of group members and its list of endorsed operators;
iii. Information concerning its structure and its main procedures (steps in the assessment process).

f. The PGS has mechanisms to ensure that producers understand:

i. The principles of organic agriculture and expected practices,
ii. The purpose and structure of the PGS and their rights for participation
iii. The role of verification and the sanctions that might be imposed on them in case of non- compliance.

g. Farm/site reviews/assessments involve a team of, at minimum 3 persons, including 1 experienced person and 1 peer operator. Experience in on-site "assessment" can have been

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acquired through training or learning-by-doing. Reciprocal[1] assessment is not considered a valid procedure.

h. The PGS has a mechanism to also receive, objectively assess and feed into the verification process the information on potential non-compliances acquired outside of the farm visits (e.g. continued "social control", external observations, consumer complaints, etc.).

i. A group with the appropriate technical experience and with at least one member producer takes the decision for the endorsement of each producer. The PGS does not delegate the decision to an external body or organization, but it is permitted to request advice from external bodies. The PGS has mechanisms to minimize conflict of interest, and to ensure consistency on the level of the assessment decision.

j. Information about compliance is generated, maintained and updated (minimum annually) for each producer. This information includes the type of production, areas of compliance and non-compliance with the standard, brought-in inputs, etc.

k. The PGS delivers specific recognition or market access to its endorsed producers only. This can be in the form of a product logo, a certificate, access to an open market place, etc.

l. The PGS allows any stakeholder, including those not directly part of the PGS group (e.g. producers of other groups, consumers, state representatives, NGOs, SAOSO representatives etc.) to visit the PGS operators (open gate policy), to participate as observer in the farm/site assessment or PGS meetings and to consult the PGS documentation. The PGS grants consumers the possibility to become active members of the PGS. The PGS communicates actively about this possibility.

m. The PGS procedures are regularly internally reviewed and improved, minimum once every two years.

n. The PGS includes on-going (minimum yearly) mechanisms for capacity building of operators and/or knowledge and advice sharing among group members.

[1] Reciprocal means that operator A assesses operator B, and B assesses A, which can create conflict of interest.

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SECTION C

APPENDIX C.

PROCEDURE FOR APPROVAL FOR USE OF THE SAOSO ORGANIC PGS ENDORSED LOGO

1. BACKGROUND

This Appendix outlines the procedure to be used for approval of the use of the SAOSO organic

PGS Endorsed logo by PGS initiatives. It should be read and used together with the Appendix B. Criteria for Approval of PGS.

2. GENERAL POLICY

a. To be granted the use of the SAOSO Organic PGS Endorsed logo PGS groups must[2] be approved by PGS South Africa (PGSSA).

b. The approval process must include persons or organisations other than those engaged in supporting the PGS group[3].

c. Approval must be based on the submission of a complete file prepared by the applicant PGS and the documented verification through file review and on-site visit by PGSSA or a person or a committee appointed by PGSSA for this purpose of the compliance of the applicant PGS with the Appendix B. Criteria for Approval of PGS and the equivalence of the PGS' standard to SAOSO's Organic Production & Processing Standards.

d. Approvals may be conditional, i.e. that the PGS shall implement some specific improvements before or after the decision has become effective.

e. The initial approval of a PGS is valid for a period of 1 year.

f. Subsequent approvals are valid for a period of 2 years.

g. The approval may be suspended or cancelled, with the latter as the last resort option, by PGSSA if serious noncompliance with the criteria is observed, following a fair and transparent process.

h. At least one month before the expiry of the approval, the approved PGS must re-submit an updated file and be subject to a file review and on-site visit by PGSSA in order to renew its approval.

SAOSO has a right of veto on the approval of PGS groups. It can therefore require PGSSA to revise their decision and revoke or suspend approval at any point in time.

[2] In this context, "must" describes a condition/criteria, "shall" an obligation (for either the SAOSO, PGSSA or the PGS) and "will" describes the procedural steps (and are in that sense an obligation to follow).

[3] This means that if one person is engaged in assistance to the PGS, at least one other person who is not engaged in assistance to the PGS must also be included in the decision-making for the approval.

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3. PROCEDURES

3.1. Inquiry

Any PGS interested in applying for approval will get from PGSSA:

a. An application form;

b. This procedure (or a simplified version of it);

c. The Appendix B. Criteria for Approval of PGS;

d. THE SAOSO Standard for Organic Production and Processing;

e. Appendix C. Procedure for Approval for Use of the South African Organic Sector Organisation (SAOSO) Organic PGS Endorsed Logo

3.2. Application

The PGS applying for approval will submit to PGSSA their file containing the following up-to-date information:

a. It's PGS Manual explaining the PGS structure and the assessment procedure in such a way that allows verification of the existence of procedures or processes that ensure compliance with the Appendix B. Criteria for Approval of PGS;

b. A completed PGS GROUP APPLICATION FORM (according to template);

c. The current list of its endorsed producers and their registered categories (i.e., crops, wild harvest, livestock, and/or processing,) of production.

3.3 Examination of File

A person or committee appointed by PGSSA will review the file and:

a. Seek clarification on any unresolved matters;

b. Determine, based on the Criteria for Approval of PGS, if the PGS has reached a sufficient stage of development to proceed with the application;

c. Assign one or more persons to make an on-site assessment visit.

3.4. On-Site Assessment Visit

An individual or group with working knowledge of PGS, appointed by PGSSA will carry out the on-site assessment visit. The visit shall include:

a. A review of the relevant documentation;

b. A review of the files of a sample number of members of the PGS;

c. On-site production premises visits of a sample of members for which the files have been

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reviewed;

d. Interviews with members of the group and other stakeholders about their understanding of organic practices, of the standards, their awareness of being part of a PGS, their personal involvement in the PGS, of their opinion on the PGS procedures and management as well as confidence in the system. Interview of members will normally be part of the visits under (c);

e. An exit discussion with the PGS members responsible for the application where the findings are presented.

The visit, decision and any applicable conditions shall be recorded in the PGS Assessment Form.

3.5. Decision

A person or committee appointed by PGSSA will review the file and the result of the on-site assessment visit and shall:

a. Seek clarification on any unresolved matters;

b. Determine if the PGS can be approved;

c. Determine any conditions that have to be fulfilled before or after licensing of the logo. Any such condition shall have a clearly spelled out time line.

The decision and any applicable conditions shall be recorded on the PGS Assessment Form

3.6. Registration and Licensing

Once a group has been approved:

a. The decision will be communicated to the PGS group by means of a standard letter;

b. A License Agreement will be signed;

c. A certificate will be issued.

d. The relevant data will be included in the Register of Logo Users.

3.7. Monitoring and Complaints

There may be on-site visits by PGSSA within the approval period to verify continued compliance if necessary.

PGSSA shall investigate in a timely manner any formal complaints received against an approved PGS group. Such an investigation shall include at least:

a. Evaluation of the nature of the complaint and if an investigation should take place;

b. Investigation of the actual situation;

c. Asking the PGS group for any comments or suggestions;

d. Asking the PGS group for any comments or corrections;

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e. Informing the complaint about the outcome.

In a complaints process, the identity of the complainant shall not be disclosed to the PGS group. PGSSA shall keep a record of complaints received and their resolutions.

NB: When there is an appeal made in reference to the outcome decision made PGSSA or its conduct, redress should be sought at SAOSO.

3.8. Transparency

The process of each approval and the basic data about the PGS groups shall be accessible[4] for any interested parties, including members of the public.

3.9. Training

The persons involved in file reviews, on site visits and decision-making regarding the approval of the PGS shall be trained to perform their functions including, but not limited to:

a. Working knowledge of PGS (i.e. familiarity with PGS basic elements and key features, practical experience with PGS implementation, etc.).

b. Knowledge about the SAOSO Standard for Organic Production and Processing.

c. The system for the use of the SAOSO organic PGS Endorsed logo, the contracts, the rules for the use of the logo etc.

d. The Appendix B. Criteria for Approval of PGS .

e. This procedure.

f. The relevant forms and templates provided by PGSSA.

3.10. Managing the Process

One person shall be responsible for the management of the whole process and each step. A file shall be kept for each PGS with all the relevant documents. The second page of the PGS APPLICATION FORM serves as a checklist to review the steps in the process.

3.11. Presenting the Case to SAOSO

When the PGS is presented to SAOSO the following shall be made available:

a. The PGS Group Application Form.

b. The PGS Assessment Form.

c. The PGS Manual or similar.

d. The signed license agreement.

[4] The exact nature of how data will be made available is left open but can include posting on the internet or available as hard copies from the PGSSA office.

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